THE HALAL TRAVEL COMPANION

81 Cities · 20 Things to Do in Each

Middle East & Gulf · Türkiye · Balkans · North Africa · Central Asia
South & Southeast Asia · East Africa · Thailand · India · Russia

From the skylines of the Gulf to the bazaars of Central Asia, the islands of the Indian Ocean to the mosques of the Balkans — a city-by-city guide for the curious Muslim traveler and anyone who loves these remarkable places.

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MIDDLE EAST AND GULF

Dubai, UAE

Halal food is available everywhere in Dubai, and Islamic culture shapes the rhythm of daily life — from the call to prayer echoing between the towers to masjids in every neighbourhood.

Dubai is dazzling—ultra-modern, high-tech, and full of ambition. Its skyline, beaches, and desert sit side by side, and its dining scene spans the entire world, with halal options on every corner and masajid woven into every neighbourhood. It is a city that makes you dream big and move fast.

20 Things to Do in Dubai

1. Visit the Burj Khalifa and enjoy the panoramic view from the observation deck.
2. Watch the spectacular Dubai Fountain show near Burj Khalifa.
3. Explore the Dubai Mall, one of the largest shopping destinations in the world.
4. Take a traditional abra boat ride across Dubai Creek.
5. Walk through the historic Al Fahidi neighbourhood and visit Al Fahidi Fort.
6. Shop for gold, spices, textiles, and perfumes in the traditional souks.
7. Go on a desert safari with dune bashing, camel riding, and a Bedouin-style dinner.
8. Relax at Jumeirah Beach, Kite Beach, or La Mer Beach.
9. Visit Palm Jumeirah and see the iconic Atlantis The Royal.
10. Enjoy dinner with skyline views in Dubai Marina.
11. Visit the Museum of the Future and explore its futuristic exhibitions.
12. Explore Global Village during the winter season.
13. Visit the Dubai Frame for views of both old and new Dubai.
14. Pray at one of the city's beautiful masajid, such as the Jumeirah Masjid, which offers guided cultural visits.
15. Take a helicopter tour or seaplane flight over the city.
16. Visit the Green Planet, an indoor tropical rainforest.
17. Go skiing or snowboarding at Ski Dubai.
18. Try cuisines from around the world, nearly all with excellent halal options.
19. Enjoy a sunset dhow cruise along Dubai Marina or Dubai Creek.
20. Wander the lantern-lit lanes of Al Seef, where old Dubai meets the new waterfront.

Abu Dhabi, UAE

Halal food is available everywhere in Abu Dhabi, and Islamic culture is the soul of the city — crowned by the magnificent Sheikh Zayed Grand Masjid.

Abu Dhabi is Dubai's calmer, grander sibling—elegant, spacious, and deeply cultural. It is home to one of the world's most breathtaking masajid, world-class museums, mangrove forests, and long golden corniches. Life here moves at a slightly slower, more gracious pace.

20 Things to Do in Abu Dhabi

1. Marvel at the Sheikh Zayed Grand Masjid, one of the largest and most beautiful masajid on earth—dress modestly and visit at sunset.
2. Explore the Louvre Abu Dhabi and its iconic floating dome.
3. Tour Qasr Al Watan, the dazzling presidential palace.
4. Walk or cycle the Corniche, with its beaches and skyline views.
5. Visit Qasr Al Hosn, the city's oldest stone building.
6. Spend a day on Yas Island: Ferrari World, Warner Bros. World, or Yas Waterworld.
7. Kayak through the mangroves at Jubail Mangrove Park or the Eastern Mangroves.
8. Relax on the white sands of Saadiyat Beach.
9. See the Falcon Hospital and learn about the UAE's beloved national bird.
10. Take in the view from the Etihad Towers observation deck.
11. Visit the Heritage Village for a glimpse of pre-oil Emirati life.
12. Stroll the Al Maryah Island waterfront and its elegant promenades.
13. Explore the dates market and sample dozens of varieties of fresh dates.
14. Pay respects at Wahat Al Karama, the moving memorial facing the Grand Masjid.
15. Enjoy halal fine dining at Emirates Palace, famous for its gold-dusted cappuccino.
16. Go dune-bashing or sandboarding in the desert on the city's edge.
17. Spend an evening at the Hudayriyat Island leisure district.
18. Tour the Yas Marina Circuit, home of the Formula 1 Grand Prix.
19. Take a boat trip to see the skyline from the water.
20. Visit the striking Zayed National Museum and the cultural district on Saadiyat Island.

Sharjah, UAE

Halal food is found on every corner in Sharjah, the cultural capital of Islamic heritage in the Emirates, where masjids and museums of Islamic civilization define the city.

Sharjah is the cultural soul of the Emirates—modest, scholarly, and proudly traditional. It is the region's capital of Islamic art and heritage, with beautifully restored souks, museums, and a warm family-friendly atmosphere. As a dry emirate with a deeply local character, it feels authentically Arab in a way its glitzier neighbours sometimes do not.

20 Things to Do in Sharjah

1. Explore the Sharjah Museum of Islamic Civilization, one of the finest of its kind.
2. Admire the elegant Al Noor Masjid on the Buhaira Corniche.
3. Shop in the beautiful Blue Souk, famous for carpets, gold, and antiques.
4. Wander the Heart of Sharjah, the lovingly restored old town.
5. Stroll Al Qasba canal and ride the Eye of the Emirates wheel.
6. Visit Souk Al Arsah, one of the oldest markets in the Gulf.
7. Enjoy the fountain show and evening atmosphere at Al Majaz Waterfront.
8. Discover desert archaeology and fossils at the Mleiha Archaeological Centre.
9. Take a day trip to the east-coast enclaves of Khor Fakkan and Kalba.
10. Visit the Sharjah Art Museum and the city's many galleries.
11. Step into the Rain Room, a mesmerising walk-through rain installation.
12. Learn at the futuristic House of Wisdom library.
13. Tour the Sharjah Aquarium and maritime museum.
14. Walk the Buhaira Corniche at sunset as masjid lights come on.
15. Browse the Central Souk's upper galleries for pashminas and gifts.
16. Explore Sharjah's desert parks and conservation reserves.
17. Take the family to Al Montazah Parks for water fun and rides.
18. Sip Arabic coffee in the courtyard cafés of the heritage area.
19. Enjoy excellent halal dining—from Emirati machboos to Indian and Levantine fare.
20. Time your visit with the Sharjah Light Festival, when the whole city glows.

AlUla, Saudi Arabia

Halal food is available everywhere in AlUla, and Islamic culture runs deep in this ancient valley, a crossroads of faith and caravan routes for millennia.

AlUla is Arabia's open-air museum—a golden desert valley of giant sandstone canyons, ancient tombs, and silent palm oases that has only recently opened to the world. It feels like Petra without the crowds, wrapped in silence and starlight. Few places on earth are this hauntingly beautiful.

20 Things to Do in AlUla

1. Explore Hegra (Madain Saleh), Saudi Arabia's first UNESCO World Heritage Site, with its monumental Nabataean tombs.
2. Watch the sunset glow on Elephant Rock, the valley's beloved natural landmark.
3. Wander the mudbrick lanes of AlUla Old Town.
4. Walk through the lush AlUla Oasis beneath towering cliffs.
5. Visit the ancient kingdom of Dadan and the Lion Tombs.

6. Read thousands of ancient inscriptions at Jabal Ikmah, the "open-air library."
7. Float over the canyons at dawn in a hot air balloon.
8. Gaze at the Milky Way in some of the darkest skies in the region.
9. See Maraya, the mirrored concert hall rising from the desert floor.
10. Take in the panorama from the Harrat Uwayrid viewpoint.
11. Hike or climb the canyon trails, including via ferrata routes.
12. Ride a vintage Land Rover through the desert on a guided safari.
13. Dine under the stars at a luxury desert camp.
14. Taste fresh dates and citrus straight from oasis farms.
15. Attend a concert or festival during the winter season.
16. Cycle the oasis trails on an e-bike.
17. Visit the old Hijaz Railway station, a relic of the Ottoman era.
18. Learn local crafts and heritage at community workshops.
19. Enjoy traditional Saudi hospitality with Arabic coffee and dates everywhere you go.
20. Simply sit in the desert silence—an experience as memorable as any monument.

Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

Halal food is available everywhere in Jeddah, the gateway of the pilgrims, where Islamic culture has welcomed the Ummah for over a thousand years.

Jeddah is the Red Sea's bride—breezy, artistic, and historically the gateway of pilgrims to Makkah. Its coral-stone old town is a UNESCO treasure, its corniche stretches for miles, and its food scene is the most cosmopolitan in the Kingdom. Jeddah is relaxed, salty-aired, and full of soul.

20 Things to Do in Jeddah

1. Wander Al-Balad, the UNESCO-listed old town with its coral-stone houses and wooden rawasheen balconies.
2. Visit the floating Al Rahmah Masjid, especially beautiful at high tide and sunset.
3. Walk the Jeddah Corniche and watch King Fahd's Fountain, the tallest of its kind in the world.
4. Dive or snorkel the Red Sea's spectacular coral reefs.
5. Tour the Tayebat Museum for a journey through Arabian history.
6. Explore the lanes and shops of Souk Al Alawi.
7. Feast on fresh Red Sea seafood—halal by nature and superb here.
8. Take a boat trip from the marina or Obhur Creek.
9. Visit the Nasseef House, where kings and traders once stayed.
10. Experience Jeddah Season concerts, food festivals, and beach events.

11. Spend an evening at the Jeddah Yacht Club and marina district.
12. Take the family to Fakieh Aquarium to meet Red Sea marine life.
13. Shop the vast Red Sea Mall or Mall of Arabia.
14. Stroll the open-air sculpture museum along the Corniche.
15. Enjoy theme-park thrills at Al Shallal.
16. Sip tea on a carpeted majlis at a traditional seaside café.
17. Watch local life at the bustling fish market at dawn.
18. Catch sunset over the Red Sea from the northern beaches.
19. Visit during Ramadan, when the old town glows with lanterns and night markets.
20. Reflect on Jeddah's centuries as the honoured gateway for millions of Hajj and Umrah pilgrims.

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Halal food is available everywhere in Riyadh, and Islamic culture anchors the capital — from the call to prayer over the skyscrapers to the great masjids of every district.

Riyadh is a capital in transformation—ancient mudbrick forts on one side, gleaming skyscrapers and giga-projects on the other. It is the beating heart of Saudi Arabia, where Najdi heritage meets one of the fastest-changing cityscapes on earth.

20 Things to Do in Riyadh

1. Stand on the Sky Bridge of the Kingdom Centre for a view over the whole city.
2. Explore At-Turaif in Diriyah, the UNESCO-listed mudbrick birthplace of the Saudi state.
3. Visit Masmak Fortress, where the modern Kingdom's story began.
4. Tour the National Museum of Saudi Arabia.
5. Experience the glittering Boulevard Riyadh City entertainment district.
6. Take a day trip to the Edge of the World, a dramatic desert escarpment.
7. Haggle for carpets, daggers, and oud at Souk Al Zal.
8. Enjoy Riyadh Season's concerts, food zones, and spectacles in winter.
9. Walk the trails and parks of the Diplomatic Quarter.
10. Visit Al Murabba Palace, King Abdulaziz's historic residence.
11. Cool off at Wadi Namar's lake and waterfall park.
12. Go quad-biking and sand-duning in the Red Sands outside the city.
13. Taste authentic Najdi cuisine—kabsa, jareesh, and sweet kleija.
14. Browse luxury boutiques and cafés at Riyadh Front and U Walk.
15. See the city glow from the Al Faisaliah Tower globe.
16. Explore King Abdullah Park and its musical fountain.

17. Visit the beautiful modern masajid, such as the King Fahd Grand Masjid, at prayer time.
18. Catch a football match or event in one of the new mega-venues.
19. Sip Saudi coffee with dates in a traditional majlis.
20. Watch how a desert capital reinvents itself—Riyadh today is a preview of tomorrow.

Abha, Saudi Arabia

Halal food is available everywhere in Abha, and Islamic culture thrives in these green mountains, where masjids crown the misty villages.

Abha is the Saudi Arabia few people imagine: a cool green mountain city wrapped in mist, where juniper forests, terraced farms, and stone villages climb into the clouds. It is the Kingdom's summer escape, and one of its most surprising and beautiful corners.

20 Things to Do in Abha

1. Ride the cable car over misty peaks to Al Soudah, the highest point in Saudi Arabia.
2. Wander Rijal Almaa, the stunning stone-and-quartz heritage village.
3. Visit the "Hanging Village" of Habala, once reachable only by rope.
4. Hike among juniper trees in Asir National Park.
5. Explore Shada Palace, a mountain fortress turned museum.
6. Browse the colourful Tuesday Market for honey, daggers, and baskets.
7. Stroll Al Muftaha art village and its galleries.
8. Taste Asiri honey and mountain ghee at local farms.
9. Drive the dramatic switchback roads with baboons watching from the cliffs.
10. Walk through the clouds along fog-covered escarpment paths.
11. See traditional Asiri houses painted in bright geometric patterns.
12. Visit the Green Mountain (Jabal Thera), glowing emerald at night.
13. Try haneeth and other highland dishes—slow-cooked, hearty, and halal.
14. Picnic by the dam lakes and parks around the city.
15. Take the cable car down to the heritage village of Al Habala's valley floor.
16. Shop for silver jewellery and embroidered textiles.
17. Visit in summer for the Abha festivals and flower-filled parks.
18. Photograph the terraced farms cut into the mountainsides.
19. Meet the famed "flower men" of the region and learn their traditions.
20. Breathe the cool mountain air—the most refreshing climate in the Gulf.

Al Ahsa, Saudi Arabia

Halal food is available everywhere in Al Ahsa, and Islamic culture here is ancient — this oasis holds one of the oldest masjids in the world.

Al Ahsa is the largest oasis in the world—a sea of more than two million date palms hiding springs, caves, palaces, and one of the oldest masajid in Islam. It is gentle, green, and steeped in layers of history going back thousands of years.

20 Things to Do in Al Ahsa

1. Explore the UNESCO-listed Al Ahsa Oasis and its endless palm groves.
2. Climb into the cool caves of Al Qarah Mountain and enjoy the summit views.
3. Visit Jawatha Masjid, among the oldest masajid in the world, where one of the earliest Friday prayers outside Madinah was held.
4. Tour the Ottoman-era Ibrahim Palace in Hofuf.
5. Wander the historic Qaisariya Souk, with its arched lanes and spice stalls.
6. Taste dozens of date varieties—Al Ahsa's khalas dates are famous across Arabia.
7. Drive out to the surreal Yellow Lake (Al Asfar) shimmering among the dunes.
8. Visit the old port town of Uqair on the Gulf coast.
9. See traditional pottery and crafts in the oasis villages.
10. Relax by natural springs that have watered this oasis for millennia.
11. Explore Hofuf's old quarters and traditional mudbrick architecture.
12. Learn the story of the oasis at the Al Ahsa heritage museums.
13. Walk the palm-shaded farm lanes at dawn.
14. Shop for woven palm-frond baskets and mats.
15. Enjoy a farm-to-table meal in the shade of the groves—simple, fresh, and halal.
16. Photograph the golden dunes rolling right up to the edge of the palms.
17. Visit the local camel and livestock markets.
18. Discover Ottoman and Abbasid-era sites scattered around Hofuf.
19. Sip Arabic coffee in a farmer's majlis and experience eastern-province hospitality.
20. Watch the oasis turn gold at sunset from the top of Al Qarah.

Dammam, Saudi Arabia

Halal food is available everywhere in Dammam, and Islamic culture gives this relaxed Gulf city its warm, family-centred rhythm.

Dammam is the laid-back capital of the Eastern Province—an easy-going coastal city of corniches, islands, and family parks, and the gateway to the oil heartland of Dhahran and the beaches of Half Moon Bay. It is unpretentious, friendly, and made for slow seaside evenings.

20 Things to Do in Dammam

1. Walk the long Dammam Corniche as fishing boats and families share the evening air.

2. Visit Ithra, the striking King Abdulaziz Center for World Culture in nearby Dhahran.
3. Relax and swim at Half Moon Bay's calm, shallow beaches.
4. Take a boat to Coral Island (Marjan) off the corniche.
5. Explore historic Tarout Island and its weathered old castle.
6. Enjoy the seaside promenade and cafés of neighbouring Al Khobar.
7. Visit the Dammam Regional Museum for Eastern Province history.
8. Take the kids to Dolphin Village and the city amusement parks.
9. Explore the interactive Scitech science center.
10. Feast on Gulf shrimp and hammour at the fish market restaurants—all halal and wonderfully fresh.
11. Shop at the huge malls along the coastal highway.
12. Drive out into the desert for dune picnics and stargazing.
13. Visit the Heritage Village for a look at pre-oil Gulf life.
14. Walk around tranquil Saihat Lake at dusk.
15. Learn about the oil story that built the region at the Aramco exhibits.
16. Enjoy evening football and local life in the city parks.
17. Take a day trip across the causeway to Bahrain.
18. Browse gold and incense in the old souks.
19. Sip karak tea at a seaside shack like a local.
20. Watch the sun set over the Gulf from the corniche's northern end.

Doha, Qatar

Halal food is available everywhere in Doha, and Islamic culture shines through its museums of Islamic art, grand masjids, and daily Qatari life.

Doha is a city of graceful contrasts: a skyline of daring architecture rising behind a timeless corniche of wooden dhows, falcon souks, and the call to prayer drifting over the bay. Compact, safe, and polished, it is one of the most welcoming capitals in the Gulf.

20 Things to Do in Doha

1. Visit the Museum of Islamic Art, a masterpiece housing one of the world's great Islamic collections.
2. Get lost in Souq Waqif—spices, falcons, fabrics, and food.
3. Walk the Corniche and watch the dhows bob against the skyline.
4. Take an evening dhow cruise along West Bay.
5. Explore the National Museum of Qatar, shaped like a desert rose.
6. Stroll Katara Cultural Village, its amphitheatre, galleries, and beach.
7. Visit the magnificent State Grand Masjid (Imam Muhammad ibn Abd al-Wahhab Masjid).
8. Shop and dine on the Riviera-style Pearl-Qatar island.

9. Ride camels and bash dunes on a desert safari to the Inland Sea (Khor Al Adaid).
10. Discover the beautifully restored Msheireb Downtown and its heritage museums.
11. Meet the falcons and falconers at the falcon souq and hospital.
12. Relax in MIA Park with the best skyline view in the city.
13. Browse art and antiques in Katara and the souq's hidden galleries.
14. Visit the futuristic Qatar National Library and Education City masajid.
15. Watch camel racing at Al Shahaniya, robots and all.
16. Tour the Sheikh Faisal Museum, an astonishing private collection.
17. Enjoy world-class halal dining everywhere—from machboos to Michelin-level tasting menus.
18. Explore Lusail, Qatar's glittering new city of the future.
19. Kayak in the mangroves of Al Thakira, a surprising green world north of the city.
20. Watch sunset from the Flag Plaza or the Katara hills as the city lights up.

Muscat, Oman

Halal food is available everywhere in Muscat, and Islamic culture graces the city — home to the breathtaking Sultan Qaboos Grand Masjid and centuries of Omani devotion.

Muscat is the gentlest of Gulf capitals—low-rise white buildings cradled between jagged mountains and a sparkling sea, where frankincense still scents the souk and no skyscraper is allowed to spoil the view. It is dignified, spotless, and quietly enchanting.

20 Things to Do in Muscat

1. Stand in awe inside the Sultan Qaboos Grand Masjid, with its hand-woven carpet and crystal chandelier.
2. Wander the labyrinth of Mutrah Souq, fragrant with frankincense and myrrh.
3. Walk the Mutrah Corniche beneath the old watchtowers at sunset.
4. See the blue-and-gold Al Alam Palace, flanked by the forts of Al Jalali and Al Mirani.
5. Attend a performance—or simply tour—the Royal Opera House Muscat.
6. Take a morning dolphin-watching cruise along the rocky coast.
7. Visit Bait Al Zubair and the National Museum for Omani heritage.
8. Hike up Mutrah Fort for the best view of the harbour.
9. Swim and picnic at Qurum Beach and the coves of Qantab.
10. Take a day trip to the turquoise pools of Wadi Shab.
11. Stop at the Bimmah Sinkhole on the coastal road.
12. Visit Nizwa's fort and famous Friday goat market on a day trip.

13. Taste shuwa—lamb slow-cooked underground—and Omani halwa with coffee.
14. Drive the mountain road to the cool plateau of Jabal Akhdar.
15. Snorkel the coral gardens of the Daymaniyat Islands.
16. Browse silver khanjar daggers and antiques in the souk.
17. Enjoy a sunset dhow cruise past cliffs and hidden coves.
18. Visit the fishing villages and forts along the Batinah coast.
19. Experience the warmth of Omani hospitality in a traditional majlis.
20. Simply enjoy a city where masajid, mountains, and sea exist in perfect balance.

Salalah, Oman

Halal food is available everywhere in Salalah, and Islamic culture is woven into the frankincense-scented life of this southern Omani gem.

Salalah is Arabia's secret garden: each summer the khareef monsoon turns its mountains into rolling green hills veiled in mist, with waterfalls, banana plantations, and wild camels wandering the roads. It is also the ancient homeland of frankincense, the gift of kings.

20 Things to Do in Salalah

1. Experience the khareef, when the mountains turn green and misty from June to September.
2. Walk among the ruins of Al Baleed and the Museum of the Frankincense Land.
3. Watch the sea explode through the blowholes at Al Mughsail Beach.
4. Picnic beside the waterfalls and pools of Wadi Darbat, with camels grazing nearby.
5. Visit the ruins of Sumhuram at Khor Rori, the ancient frankincense port.
6. Buy frankincense and bukhoor at the Al Haffa souk.
7. Tour the Sultan Qaboos Masjid, Salalah's elegant main masjid.
8. Drive up to the viewpoints of Jabal Samhan above the clouds.
9. Explore Taqah Castle and its fishing-village charm.
10. Visit Mirbat, the old frankincense harbour, and its fort.
11. Cool off at the springs of Ayn Razat and Ayn Sahalnoot.
12. Eat fresh coconut, banana, and papaya from roadside stalls.
13. Taste Dhofari specialties like camel mishkak and madhbi—hearty and halal.
14. Relax on white-sand beaches that feel like the tropics.
15. Look for flamingos and herons in the coastal lagoons.
16. Shop for silver and Dhofari textiles in the old town.
17. Take a 4x4 into the mountains to meet Jibbali communities.
18. Watch the sunset from the cliffs of Al Mughsail.
19. Learn the 5,000-year story of the frankincense trade.
20. Enjoy the rare pleasure of rain in Arabia during the monsoon months.

Manama, Bahrain

Halal food is available everywhere in Manama, and Islamic culture is ever-present — from Al Fateh Grand Masjid to the ancient masjids of the pearling towns.

Manama is small, cosmopolitan, and layered—an island capital where a 4,000-year-old Dilmun fort, glittering towers, and one of the Gulf's grandest masajid all fit within a few kilometres. Bahrain's pearl-diving soul still glimmers beneath the modern surface.

20 Things to Do in Manama

1. Visit Al Fateh Grand Masjid, one of the largest masajid in the world, with free guided tours.
2. Explore the Bahrain National Museum, a beautiful introduction to the island's 5,000 years.
3. Enter the old city through Bab Al Bahrain and dive into the Manama Souq.
4. Wander the UNESCO-listed Bahrain Fort at sunset.
5. Follow the Pearling Path in Muharraq, a UNESCO tribute to the pearl divers.
6. Drive out to the mysterious Tree of Life, thriving alone in the desert.
7. See the ancient Dilmun Burial Mounds scattered across the island.
8. Visit Beit Al Quran, a museum housing rare Quranic manuscripts.
9. Walk the Bahrain Bay waterfront and World Trade Center skyline.
10. Dine in the restaurant blocks of Adliya and Block 338—excellent halal options abound.
11. Visit the Bahrain International Circuit, home of Formula 1's night race.
12. Relax on the beaches and islands of Amwaj.
13. See Arabian oryx and gazelles at Al Areen Wildlife Park.
14. Explore Muharraq's old houses, masajid, and pearling merchant mansions.
15. Shop the City Centre and Seef malls, or the old gold souk.
16. Take a boat trip to the island forts and fishing spots.
17. Sip cardamom tea in a traditional souq café.
18. Visit the Al Khamis Masjid, one of the oldest in the Gulf region.
19. Watch the sunset from the Four Seasons' bay-side promenade.
20. Enjoy an island where masajid, churches, and temples have stood side by side for generations.

Kuwait City, Kuwait

Halal food is available everywhere in Kuwait City, and Islamic culture shapes the capital, from its Grand Masjid to the Bedouin heritage of its diwaniyas.

Kuwait City is the Gulf's quiet intellectual—home to the region's oldest cultural scene, its beloved Towers, and a corniche made for sunset walks. It blends proud

Bedouin roots with a nostalgic, mid-century charm found nowhere else in Arabia.

20 Things to Do in Kuwait City

1. Go up the Kuwait Towers, the country's beloved symbol, for panoramic Gulf views.
2. Visit the Grand Masjid, Kuwait's largest, with its elegant Andalusian-inspired design.
3. Feast and haggle in Souq Al-Mubarakiya, the historic heart of the city.
4. Stroll the green terraces and museums of Al Shaheed Park.
5. Explore the Sadu House and the art of Bedouin weaving.
6. Visit the Scientific Center and its aquarium on the corniche.
7. Walk the Marina Crescent and watch the dhows and yachts.
8. Take a boat trip to Failaka Island, with its Greek and Gulf War-era ruins.
9. Admire the Tareq Rajab Museum's Islamic art and calligraphy.
10. Tour the Sheikh Jaber Al-Ahmad Cultural Centre, a jewel of modern architecture.
11. See the mirrored mosaics of the eccentric, delightful Mirror House.
12. Browse the Islamic-era heritage of the Kuwait National Museum.
13. Enjoy halal seafood—try zubaidi, Kuwait's beloved pomfret, grilled or in machboos.
14. Walk the full seaside corniche from the Towers to the Scientific Center.
15. Visit the historic Red Palace at Jahra.
16. Shop the Avenues, one of the largest malls in the region.
17. Take a desert trip in winter for camping, camel rides, and bonfires.
18. Watch the fountains and gardens of Green Island.
19. Visit the House of Sabah museums in the old Kuwaiti neighbourhoods.
20. Experience Kuwaiti hospitality over gahwa and dates in a diwaniya.

Amman, Jordan

Halal food is available everywhere in Amman, and Islamic culture fills the city — masjids on every hill and some of the Levant's finest halal kitchens.

Amman is one of the oldest continuously inhabited cities on earth—white limestone hills stacked with Roman ruins, Ottoman houses, lively souks, and some of the friendliest people in the Middle East. It is also the perfect base for Jordan's wonders, and a paradise for halal food lovers.

20 Things to Do in Amman

1. Explore the Amman Citadel, with its Roman, Byzantine, and Umayyad ruins and sweeping views.
2. Sit in the great Roman Theatre carved into the hillside.
3. Visit the blue-domed King Abdullah I Masjid, which welcomes respectful visitors.

4. Wander downtown (Al Balad) and its spice-scented souks.
5. Stroll and people-watch on Rainbow Street.
6. See the Dead Sea Scrolls at the Jordan Museum.
7. Eat at Hashem, the legendary downtown falafel institution—cheap, famous, and fully halal.
8. Queue for hot knafeh at Habibah, a rite of passage.
9. Taste mansaf, Jordan's national dish of lamb, rice, and jameed yoghurt.
10. Take a day trip to Jerash, one of the best-preserved Roman cities anywhere.
11. Float effortlessly in the Dead Sea, the lowest point on earth.
12. Visit Madaba's mosaic map and Mount Nebo, where Moses looked upon the Promised Land.
13. Browse contemporary Arab art at Darat al Funun.
14. Explore the royal car collection at the Royal Automobile Museum.
15. Sip Arabic coffee in the cafés of Weibdeh, Amman's bohemian quarter.
16. Watch the sunset from the Citadel as the calls to prayer echo across the hills.
17. Haggle for sweets, spices, and ka'ak bread in the downtown markets.
18. Visit the Cave of the Seven Sleepers (Al-Rajib), mentioned in the Quran's Surah Al-Kahf.
19. Take a cooking class and learn Jordanian home dishes.
20. Use Amman as your gateway to Petra, Wadi Rum, and Aqaba.

Aqaba, Jordan

Halal food is available everywhere in Aqaba, and Islamic culture runs deep — the ruins of Ayla, one of the first purpose-built Islamic cities, stand beside the sea.

Aqaba is Jordan's window on the Red Sea—a relaxed resort town where coral reefs begin metres from shore, and the mountains of four countries frame the horizon. Warm water, fresh fish, and easy access to Petra and Wadi Rum make it irresistible.

20 Things to Do in Aqaba

1. Snorkel or dive the coral gardens of the Aqaba Marine Park.
2. Dive the famous Cedar Pride shipwreck, draped in soft coral.
3. Take a glass-bottom boat trip over the reefs.
4. Explore the Mamluk-era Aqaba Fort and the Ayla ruins, one of the first purpose-built Islamic cities.
5. Relax on the public and resort beaches along the South Beach coast.
6. Feast on sayadieh—spiced fish and rice—Aqaba's signature halal dish.
7. Take a full-day boat trip with swimming, sunbathing, and a barbecue lunch.
8. Visit the striking white Sharif Hussein bin Ali Masjid.
9. Browse the fish market and pick your catch for lunch.

10. Try parasailing, jet-skiing, or a banana-boat ride.
11. Take a day trip into the majestic desert of Wadi Rum.
12. Take a day trip to the rose-red wonder of Petra.
13. Watch the sunset where Jordan, Egypt, Israel, and Saudi Arabia meet.
14. Visit the Aqaba Bird Observatory during migration season.
15. Stroll the marina and new Ayla oasis district in the evening.
16. Swim with a view from the Berenice Beach Club.
17. Splash around at the Saraya waterpark.
18. Shop for spices and Dead Sea products in the town souks.
19. Enjoy a quiet evening of shisha-free seaside cafés and fresh juices.
20. Watch fishermen mend their nets at dawn in the old harbour.

Baku, Azerbaijan

Halal food is available everywhere in Baku, a Muslim-majority capital where masjids crown the skyline and Islamic heritage fills the walled old city.

Baku is where East meets West on the Caspian shore—a medieval walled city crowned by the Maiden Tower, ringed by Parisian-style boulevards and futuristic Flame Towers. Muslim-majority yet proudly cosmopolitan, it is one of the most surprising and stylish cities between Europe and Asia.

20 Things to Do in Baku

1. Wander Icherisheher, the UNESCO-listed Old City, within its ancient walls.
2. Climb the mysterious Maiden Tower for views over the Caspian.
3. Tour the Palace of the Shirvanshahs, a jewel of medieval Islamic architecture.
4. Admire Zaha Hadid's flowing Heydar Aliyev Center.
5. Watch the Flame Towers light up the night sky.
6. Walk the Baku Boulevard along the Caspian at sunset.
7. Visit the Carpet Museum, shaped like a giant rolled carpet.
8. Take a day trip to the Gobustan rock art and bubbling mud volcanoes.
9. Visit the Ateshgah Fire Temple and the eternally burning Yanar Dag.
10. Stroll Nizami Street and Fountains Square in the evening.
11. Ride a gondola through "Little Venice" on the boulevard.
12. Take in the panorama from Highland Park and the Martyrs' Lane memorial.
13. Haggle for pomegranates, saffron, and sweets at Taza Bazaar.
14. Feast on Azerbaijani cuisine—plov, kebabs, and qutab—widely halal and delicious.
15. Visit the grand masajid, such as the Bibi-Heybat Masjid on the Caspian shore.
16. Ride the Baku Eye ferris wheel on the waterfront.
17. Sip tea with jam in a traditional çayxana teahouse.

18. Take a boat ride on the Caspian for the city's best profile.
19. Explore the Philharmonic gardens and the old European quarter.
20. Day-trip into the Caucasus foothills for mountain villages and fresh air.

Ganja, Azerbaijan

Halal food is available everywhere in Ganja, and Islamic culture has flourished here for over a thousand years — its shrines and masjids are among the oldest in the Caucasus.

Ganja is Azerbaijan's soulful second city—an ancient Silk Road stop of red-brick masajid, Persian mausoleums, and tree-lined squares, and the birthplace of the great poet Nizami. Slower and more traditional than Baku, it is the gateway to the mountain lakes of the Caucasus.

20 Things to Do in Ganja

1. Visit the elegant Nizami Mausoleum, honouring Azerbaijan's greatest poet.
2. See the red-brick Shah Abbas (Juma) Masjid in the old centre.
3. Pay respects at the Imamzadeh complex, one of Azerbaijan's most important Muslim shrines.
4. Walk through the old fortress gates into the historic centre.
5. Marvel at the Bottle House, built from thousands of glass bottles.
6. Relax in Khan Baghi, one of the oldest parks in the Caucasus.
7. Take a day trip to stunning Lake Goygol, ringed by forested mountains.
8. Continue up to the emerald waters of Maralgol above Goygol.
9. Explore the local bazaar for farm produce, spices, and sweets.
10. Sip tea in a shaded çayxana and watch unhurried Ganja life go by.
11. Taste local dishes like dovga soup and dushbara dumplings—halal and homemade.
12. Admire the grand Heydar Aliyev Square and City Hall architecture.
13. Visit the historical masajid and hammams of the old quarters.
14. Drive through the former German colony of Helenendorf (Goygol town).
15. Hike in the foothills of the Lesser Caucasus.
16. Pick up local jams, dried fruits, and mountain honey.
17. Visit the Ganja fortress remnants and city gates at dusk.
18. Meet artisans weaving carpets and crafting copper.
19. Enjoy an evening promenade with local families along the central streets.
20. Use Ganja as a base for exploring western Azerbaijan's lakes, forests, and canyons.

TÜRKIYE

Istanbul, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Istanbul, and Islamic culture defines the city — the city of a thousand masjids, Ottoman glory, and the call to prayer over two continents.

Istanbul is the city of two continents and a thousand masajid—where Byzantine domes stand beside Ottoman minarets, ferries cross between Europe and Asia, and the call to prayer rolls over seven hills at dusk. For the Muslim traveler, it is one of the greatest cities on earth: halal food everywhere, prayer spaces on every corner, and history that never ends.

20 Things to Do in Istanbul

1. Stand beneath the great dome of Hagia Sophia, now once again a working masjid.
2. Visit the Blue Masjid and its six minarets facing the Hippodrome.
3. Explore Topkapi Palace, seat of Ottoman sultans for four centuries, and its sacred relics.
4. Get wonderfully lost in the Grand Bazaar's 4,000 shops.
5. Breathe in the Spice Bazaar—saffron, Turkish delight, and mountain teas.
6. Take a Bosphorus cruise between Europe and Asia.
7. Descend into the mysterious Basilica Cistern.
8. Climb the Galata Tower for the classic skyline view.
9. Stroll Istiklal Street and ride the nostalgic red tram.
10. Tour the opulent Dolmabahce Palace on the Bosphorus shore.
11. Admire the Suleymaniye Masjid, Sinan's masterpiece, with its panoramic terrace.
12. Wander the rainbow-coloured streets of Balat and Fener.
13. Take the ferry to Kadikoy and eat your way through the Asian side's markets.
14. Visit Camlica Masjid, Türkiye's largest, with stunning city views.
15. Escape to the car-free Princes' Islands for the day.
16. Indulge in a full Turkish breakfast—an unhurried feast of cheeses, olives, honey, and kaymak.
17. Experience a traditional hamam in a historic marble bathhouse.
18. Try the city's legendary street food: simit, balik ekmek, kumpir in Ortakoy, and baklava in Karakoy.
19. Watch whirling dervishes in an evening sema ceremony.
20. End the day on a rooftop as a hundred minarets are silhouetted against the sunset.

Cappadocia / Göreme, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Cappadocia, and Islamic culture has shaped these valleys for centuries — cave-town masjids and warm Anatolian hospitality await.

Cappadocia is a dreamscape—valleys of "fairy chimney" rock spires, cave churches, underground cities, and, at dawn, a sky filled with a hundred hot air balloons. Göreme, at its heart, is one of the most magical small towns you will ever sleep in.

20 Things to Do in Cappadocia / Göreme

1. Rise before dawn for a hot air balloon flight over the fairy chimneys—the experience of a lifetime.
2. Explore the Göreme Open-Air Museum's rock-cut churches and frescoes.
3. Descend into the underground cities of Derinkuyu or Kaymakli.
4. Hike the Red and Rose Valleys at golden hour.
5. Climb Uchisar Castle, the highest point in Cappadocia.
6. Sleep in a cave hotel carved from living rock.
7. Wander Pasabag (Monks Valley) among the strangest fairy chimneys.
8. Walk the gorge of Ihlara Valley, dotted with hidden churches.
9. Try your hand at the potter's wheel in Avanos, using Hittite-era red clay.
10. Ride horses through the valleys at sunset—Cappadocia means "land of beautiful horses."
11. Take an ATV tour to the sunset viewpoints.
12. Photograph Pigeon Valley's carved dovecotes.
13. Watch the balloons from a Göreme rooftop terrace with morning tea.
14. Visit the rock fortress and village of Cavusin.
15. See the fairy-tale rock formations of Devrent (Imagination) Valley.
16. Browse carpets and lanterns in Göreme's bazaars.
17. Feast on testi kebab, slow-cooked in a sealed clay pot—halal and theatrical.
18. Hike to Love Valley for the classic panoramic photo.
19. Explore the underground monastic complex of Zelve Open-Air Museum.
20. Stargaze from your terrace—the valleys are silent and dark after midnight.

Antalya, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Antalya, and Islamic culture graces the old town's Ottoman lanes, historic masjids, and halal-friendly resorts.

Antalya is the pearl of the Turkish Riviera—a Roman harbour city wrapped around a clifftop old town, with turquoise water on one side and the snow-dusted Taurus Mountains on the other. Beaches, waterfalls, and ancient cities all sit within an hour of its charming Kaleiçi lanes.

20 Things to Do in Antalya

1. Wander Kaleiçi, the old town of Ottoman houses above the Roman harbour.
2. Pass through Hadrian's Gate, standing since 130 AD.
3. Watch the Duden Waterfalls pour off the cliffs into the sea.
4. Swim at Konyaalti Beach beneath the mountains.
5. Take the Tunektepe cable car for a bird's-eye view of the bay.
6. Sail on a pirate-boat or yacht trip along the cliff coast.
7. Sit in the magnificent Roman theatre of Aspendos, still in use today.
8. Walk the colonnaded streets of ancient Perge.
9. Climb to Termessos, the mountain city Alexander the Great never conquered.
10. Go white-water rafting in Köprülü Canyon.
11. Visit the eternal flames of the Chimaera on Mount Chimaera at night.
12. Explore the Antalya Museum, one of Türkiye's best.
13. See the fluted Yivli Minaret, symbol of the city, and its neighbouring masajid.
14. Cool off in the Antalya Aquarium's tunnel tanks.
15. Day-trip to Olympos, where ruins lie hidden in a river valley by the sea.
16. Relax at Lara Beach and its all-inclusive resorts, many with halal-certified kitchens and alcohol-free options.
17. Shop the old bazaar for leather, spices, and Turkish delight.
18. Visit the ancient harbour by night, lit and lively with tea gardens.
19. Hike a stretch of the Lycian Way, Türkiye's legendary coastal trail.
20. Watch the sun sink into the Mediterranean from the old town cliffs.

Bodrum, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Bodrum, and Islamic culture is part of the peninsula's fabric — masjids overlook the marina and halal kitchens line the coast.

Bodrum is the Aegean's whitewashed playground—a crusader castle guarding a double bay, gulet yachts bobbing in the marina, and bougainvillea spilling over blue-shuttered houses. It has been beloved of sailors since the days of Herodotus, who was born here.

20 Things to Do in Bodrum

1. Explore Bodrum Castle and its fascinating Museum of Underwater Archaeology.
2. Visit the site of the Mausoleum at Halicarnassus, one of the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World.
3. Sail on a traditional wooden gulet for a "blue cruise" day trip.
4. Swim at the beaches of Bitez, Gumbet, and Bardakci.
5. Watch the sunset from the old windmills above the twin bays.
6. Sit in the restored ancient amphitheatre with its sea view.

7. Wander the marina and admire the classic wooden yachts.
8. Haggle in the bazaar and textile markets.
9. Take a boat to hidden coves and the island of Karaada.
10. Visit the Myndos Gate, last remnant of Halicarnassus's ancient walls.
11. Day-trip by ferry to the Greek island of Kos.
12. Enjoy a seaside dinner of grilled fish and Aegean mezes—halal-friendly and superb.
13. Visit the Zeki Müren Arts Museum, honouring Türkiye's beloved singer.
14. Explore the charming stone villages of the Bodrum peninsula.
15. Go scuba diving among Aegean reefs and wrecks.
16. Relax at a beach club by day and a quiet waterfront tea garden by night.
17. Visit the ancient theatre and ruins of Pedasa in the hills.
18. Browse the weekly farmers' markets for olives, figs, and honey.
19. Photograph the classic white houses of the old town lanes.
20. Take a sunset walk along the castle walls as the muezzin's call echoes across the harbour.

Pamukkale, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Pamukkale, and Islamic culture is alive in the town's masjids and family-run pensions serving home-cooked halal meals.

Pamukkale—the "Cotton Castle"—is a mountainside of brilliant white travertine terraces filled with warm, mineral-rich water, crowned by the ancient spa city of Hierapolis. It looks like snow in the tropics and feels like bathing in a dream.

20 Things to Do in Pamukkale

1. Walk barefoot up the dazzling white travertine terraces, as all visitors must.
2. Soak in the warm pools overlooking the valley below.
3. Swim among submerged Roman columns in the Antique Pool (Cleopatra's Pool).
4. Explore the vast ruins of Hierapolis, a UNESCO World Heritage city.
5. Sit in Hierapolis's grand theatre, one of the finest in Anatolia.
6. Wander the ancient necropolis, among the largest in Türkiye.
7. Watch sunrise or sunset turn the white terraces pink and gold.
8. Float over the travertines in a hot air balloon at dawn.
9. Paraglide above the terraces for an unforgettable view.
10. Visit the Hierapolis Archaeology Museum in the old Roman baths.
11. Bathe in the red mineral springs of Karahayit next door.
12. Explore Kaklik Cave, an "underground Pamukkale" of hidden travertines.
13. Take a day trip to the magnificent ruins of Aphrodisias.
14. Visit ancient Laodicea, one of the Seven Churches of Revelation.

15. Day-trip to turquoise Salda Lake, "Türkiye's Maldives."
16. Shop the textile town of Buldan, famous for hand-loomed fabrics.
17. Stay in a family-run pension and enjoy home-cooked halal village meals.
18. Photograph the terraces from the lower pools with sunset reflections.
19. Try local Denizli specialties—roast meats, fresh flatbreads, and grape molasses.
20. End the day soaking your feet in a warm mineral stream as the day-trippers leave.

Fethiye, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Fethiye, and Islamic culture blends with Lycian history — masjids stand among ancient tombs and halal seafood fills the fish market.

Fethiye is where the turquoise coast shows off—the Blue Lagoon of Ölüdeniz, paragliders floating down from Mount Babadağ, ancient Lycian tombs carved into cliffs, and island-dotted bays made for boat days. It is one of the most beautiful stretches of coast in the Mediterranean.

20 Things to Do in Fethiye

1. Swim in the Blue Lagoon of Ölüdeniz, one of the world's most photographed beaches.
2. Paraglide from Mount Babadağ down to the sea—one of the world's great paragliding sites.
3. Take a boat trip to Butterfly Valley, a hidden gorge beach.
4. Cruise the Twelve Islands of the gulf, swimming in deserted coves.
5. Visit the Lycian rock tombs of Amyntas above the town.
6. Walk through the haunting ghost village of Kayaköy.
7. Wade the icy canyon of Saklikent Gorge.
8. Explore the ruins of Tlos, one of the oldest Lycian cities.
9. Hike a section of the Lycian Way along the coast.
10. Take the cable car up Babadağ for sunset above the clouds.
11. Watch the sunset from Çalis Beach with grilled fish for dinner.
12. Pick your own fish at the famous fish market and have it cooked on the spot—fresh and halal.
13. Dive among reefs, caves, and ancient amphorae.
14. Visit Gemiler Island with its Byzantine church ruins.
15. Browse the huge Tuesday market for produce and textiles.
16. Escape to the quiet mountain valley of Kabak.
17. Go sea kayaking along the rocky coast.
18. Relax in the shade of the town's palm-lined promenade.
19. Take a jeep safari into the pine-covered mountains.

20. Toast the day with fresh pomegranate juice on a boat deck at sunset.

Izmir, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Izmir, and Islamic culture has flourished on this Aegean shore for centuries — Ottoman masjids and bazaars fill the old city.

Izmir is the Aegean's easy-going metropolis—laid-back, liberal, and bathed in light, with a long seaside Kordon promenade, an ancient agora, and some of Türkiye's best food. It is also the gateway to Ephesus, one of the greatest ancient cities on earth.

20 Things to Do in Izmir

1. Walk or cycle the Kordon, Izmir's beloved seaside promenade, at sunset.
2. Get lost in the labyrinth of the Kemeralti Bazaar, a market since Ottoman days.
3. Ride the historic Asansör tower elevator up to the best city view.
4. See the iconic Clock Tower in Konak Square.
5. Climb to Kadifekale, the Velvet Castle, overlooking the whole bay.
6. Explore the Roman Agora of Smyrna in the city centre.
7. Take a day trip to Ephesus, walking its marble streets to the Library of Celsus.
8. Visit the mountain village of Sirince, famous for fruit, crafts, and old Greek houses.
9. Day-trip to the beach towns of Cesme and Alacati, with their stone houses and windmills.
10. Ride the ferry across the bay for the price of a tea.
11. Try Izmir's specialties: boyoz pastry, kumru sandwiches, and fresh Aegean seafood.
12. Visit the hilltop ruins of Pergamon on another rewarding day trip.
13. Stroll the Kulturpark, the city's leafy central fairground.
14. Dine along the lively waterfront of Alsancak and Kordonboyu.
15. Ride the Balcova cable car to pine forests and picnic spots.
16. Visit the Izmir Archaeology and Ethnography museums.
17. Meet the animals at the Sasali wildlife park.
18. Sip Turkish coffee in a Kemeralti courtyard han.
19. Enjoy the sunset from the hilltop terraces of the Jewish heritage quarter.
20. Soak up a city that has been a meeting point of faiths and cultures for 3,000 years.

Trabzon, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Trabzon, and Islamic culture runs deep along the Black Sea — highland masjids and centuries of devotion crown the green hills.

Trabzon is the jewel of the Black Sea—a green, rain-washed city of tea gardens, hazelnuts, and misty mountains, where Sumela Monastery clings impossibly to a cliff and every meal ends with tea. It is Türkiye at its most lush and least expected.

20 Things to Do in Trabzon

1. Visit the breathtaking Sumela Monastery, hanging off a cliff face in the forest.
2. Day-trip to Uzungöl, the mirror-still alpine lake ringed by minarets and wooden masajid.
3. Soak in the highland air of the Ayder plateau and its hot springs.
4. See the Trabzon Hagia Sophia, a Byzantine church-turned-masjid with vivid frescoes.
5. Tour the Atatürk Mansion in its pine groves.
6. Sip tea at the Boztepe viewpoint above the city and sea.
7. Walk the walls of Trabzon Castle and the old town.
8. Taste Black Sea cuisine: mihlama (cheesy cornmeal), hamsi (anchovies), and Akçaabat köfte—hearty and halal.
9. Browse the old bazaar for copperware, silver, and hazelnuts.
10. Explore the Trabzon Museum in its Italian-style mansion.
11. Visit the serene masajid of the old city, including Gülbahar Hatun Masjid.
12. Take a tea-plantation tour in neighbouring Rize, the tea capital.
13. Drive the dramatic Zigana Pass through the Pontic Alps.
14. Descend into the cool depths of Çal Cave.
15. Picnic by Sera Lake just outside town.
16. Experience the yayla (highland pasture) culture in summer festivals.
17. Watch fishermen haul in their catch at the Black Sea harbour.
18. Stroll the seaside promenade at Ganita at dusk.
19. Shop for Trabzon's famous hand-woven silver bracelets.
20. Breathe the rain-washed air—this is Türkiye's greenest corner.

Bursa, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Bursa, the first Ottoman capital — a city of great masjids, sacred tombs, and the very cradle of Ottoman Islamic culture.

Bursa was the first capital of the Ottoman Empire, and it still breathes that early Ottoman grace—great masajid, silk bazaars, thermal baths, and the snow-capped peak of Uludağ rising behind it all. It is also the birthplace of İskender kebab. Enough said.

20 Things to Do in Bursa

1. Stand beneath the twenty domes of the Grand Masjid (Ulu Cami), a forest of pillars and calligraphy.
2. Admire the emerald tiles of the Green Masjid and Green Tomb.

3. Ride the teleferik cable car—one of the world's longest—up Mount Uludağ.
4. Ski or snowboard Uludağ in winter; hike its meadows in summer.
5. Wander Cumalıkızık, the perfectly preserved 700-year-old Ottoman village, for a village breakfast.
6. Browse silk scarves at Koza Han, the historic cocoon bazaar.
7. Visit the Emir Sultan Masjid and its peaceful courtyard.
8. Watch the sunset from Tophane, beside the clock tower and the tombs of the founding sultans.
9. Feast on İskender kebab where it was invented—halal, buttery, and legendary.
10. Soak in a historic thermal hamam, as visitors have for centuries.
11. Sit beneath the 600-year-old plane tree at İnkaya.
12. Explore the Muradiye complex of royal tombs and gardens.
13. Visit the lakeside village of Gölyazı on its little island.
14. Tour the Bursa City Museum and the city's silk heritage.
15. Buy chestnut candy and Bursa's famous peaches.
16. Walk the old bazaar quarter of bedestens and hans.
17. Visit the Saitabat waterfall in the hills of Kestel.
18. Explore the Great Masjid's neighbouring tombs of early Ottoman sultans.
19. Enjoy the panoramic night view from the cable car station.
20. Slow down—Bursa rewards those who wander without a plan.

Marmaris, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Marmaris, and Islamic culture is part of harbour life — the castle masjid and waterfront grills welcome Muslim travelers warmly.

Marmaris is the Mediterranean's harbour town par excellence—a pine-cloaked bay so beautiful that Sultan Süleyman reportedly ordered it built into a jewel. Days here are for boats, islands, and pine-scented air; evenings for marina strolls and grilled fish.

20 Things to Do in Marmaris

1. Take an all-day boat trip around the bay's islands and swimming coves.
2. Day-trip to Sedir Island (Cleopatra Island) and its legendary golden beach.
3. Visit Marmaris Castle and its little museum above the marina.
4. Wander the old town lanes behind the harbour.
5. Swim at Içmeler and Turunç, the neighbouring beach towns.
6. Go scuba diving in the clear Aegean-Mediterranean waters.
7. Take a jeep safari into the pine forests and waterfalls.
8. Visit Dalyan: mud baths, ancient Kaunos, and the turtle beach of Iztuzu.
9. Hike or cycle the Marmaris National Park trails above the bay.
10. Haggle in the Grand Bazaar and the harbour markets.

11. Enjoy watersports—parasailing, jet skis, and paddleboards.
12. Visit the Nimara Cave on Heaven Island.
13. Cool off at the Turgut waterfall and its shaded pools.
14. Ride horses through the forests on a horseback safari.
15. Take the family to the aquaparks.
16. Dine on fresh-caught fish along the marina—halal and straight from the boat.
17. Watch the sunset from the castle walls or a beachfront tea garden.
18. Join a Turkish night of folk dance and music at a harbour venue.
19. Take a quiet morning walk along the marina before the boats set out.
20. Simply float in one of the clearest bays in the Mediterranean.

Alanya, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Alanya, and Islamic culture shines from the Seljuk masjids on the castle rock to the town's many halal-friendly resorts.

Alanya is a tale of two beaches split by a great castle-crowned headland, where Seljuk walls drop straight into the sea. It is sunny, friendly, and famously welcoming to Muslim families, with halal hotels and masjid minarets sharing the skyline with palm trees.

20 Things to Do in Alanya

1. Climb or ride the cable car up to Alanya Castle for the great coastal panorama.
2. Swim at Kleopatra Beach, where the queen herself is said to have bathed.
3. Visit the octagonal Red Tower, symbol of the city.
4. Explore the stalactite chambers of Damlataş Cave.
5. Take a boat trip around the castle peninsula and its sea caves.
6. Walk the medieval Seljuk shipyard (Tersane) on the harbour.
7. Dine at a floating riverside restaurant on the cool Dim River.
8. Explore the vast chambers of Dim Cave.
9. Hike or picnic in Sapadere Canyon among waterfalls.
10. Visit the Alanya Museum and its bronze statue of Herakles.
11. Wander the ruins of hilltop Syedra in the banana groves.
12. Paraglide onto Kleopatra Beach from the cliffs above.
13. Take a jeep safari into the Taurus Mountains and village lunch stops.
14. Stroll the lively harbour and lighthouse at sunset.
15. Shop the bazaar for Turkish delight, textiles, and leather.
16. Enjoy a long Turkish breakfast in the hills above the town.
17. Day-trip to the Manavgat Waterfall and its riverside market.
18. Relax at one of the region's many halal-friendly, alcohol-free family resorts.
19. Visit the illuminated castle by night, glowing above the sea.

20. End the day with tea and sahlab on the harbour promenade.

Konya, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Konya, the spiritual heart of Türkiye — the city of Rumi, where Islamic culture and Sufi tradition breathe in every street.

Konya is the spiritual heart of Türkiye—the city of Rumi, where the whirling dervishes turn in remembrance of God and Seljuk masajid and madrasas line quiet, dignified streets. It is conservative, contemplative, and deeply moving.

20 Things to Do in Konya

1. Visit the Mevlana Museum, the shrine-tomb of Jalaluddin Rumi—one of the most visited spiritual sites in Türkiye.
2. Witness a sema, the whirling dervish ceremony, in its spiritual home.
3. See the tomb of Shams Tabrizi, Rumi's beloved teacher.
4. Explore the Seljuk wonders of the İnce Minare and Karatay tile museums.
5. Walk Alaeddin Hill, with its great Seljuk masjid and tea gardens.
6. Visit the serene Aziziye Masjid with its Ottoman-baroque flair.
7. Wander the restored stone-and-mudbrick village of Sille.
8. Feast on Konya's specialties: etli ekmek, firin kebabi, and tandir lamb—proudly halal local cuisine.
9. Day-trip to Çatalhöyük, one of the world's oldest known settlements.
10. Day-trip to the blinding white expanse of Tuz Gölü, the Salt Lake.
11. Visit the Panorama Museum and the story of the Mevlevi order.
12. Stroll the Butterfly Garden, one of the largest in Europe.
13. Explore the old Bedesten bazaar and its copper and carpet shops.
14. Visit the Shams park and the city's green cultural quarters.
15. Learn at the Konya Science Center, popular with families.
16. Admire Seljuk stonework on the old city gates and caravanserais.
17. Browse spiritual books and Rumi poetry in the museum quarter shops.
18. Sip tea with the famously gentle Konya locals in a park çay bahçesi.
19. Visit during the Şeb-i Arus festival in December, when dervishes from everywhere gather.
20. Leave space for stillness—Konya teaches you to listen.

Ankara, Türkiye

Halal food is available everywhere in Ankara, and Islamic culture stands proud — from the vast Kocatepe Masjid to the Ottoman lanes of the old citadel.

Ankara is Türkiye's purposeful capital—often overlooked, but home to the country's greatest museum, Atatürk's monumental mausoleum, a hilltop citadel,

and the vast white Kocatepe Masjid. Quiet, authentic, and unpretentious, it shows the real Anatolian heart of the republic.

20 Things to Do in Ankara

1. Pay respects at Anıtkabir, the majestic mausoleum of Atatürk, and watch the changing of the guard.
2. Visit the Museum of Anatolian Civilizations—one of the finest museums in the world.
3. Explore Ankara Castle and the restored old town within its walls.
4. Visit the Hacı Bayram Masjid beside the Roman Temple of Augustus.
5. Stand beneath the vast dome of Kocatepe Masjid, the city's landmark.
6. Ride up Atakule tower for a revolving-view dinner or tea.
7. Wander Hamamönü, the restored Ottoman quarter of wooden houses and cafés.
8. Visit the Rahmi M. Koç Museum of industry and transport in a historic han.
9. Explore the Ethnography and War of Independence museums.
10. Relax in Gençlik Park and ride its miniature train.
11. Stroll the old Ulus district and its markets.
12. See contemporary art at CerModern, in the old railway workshops.
13. Take a day trip to Beypazarı, an Ottoman town famous for silverwork and carrots.
14. Cycle around Eymir Lake in the pine woods.
15. Try Ankara's famous döner and the hearty dishes of old Anatolian kitchens—all halal.
16. Visit the Roman Baths ruins and the Column of Julian.
17. Browse the antique and craft shops of the castle district.
18. Visit the giant aquarium and shopping centres of the modern districts.
19. Watch the sunset from the castle walls over a sea of red roofs.
20. Enjoy a city where the ancient and the republican stand side by side.

BALKANS

Kotor, Montenegro

Halal food can be found in Kotor — fresh Adriatic seafood, grills, and halal-friendly restaurants — and Montenegro's Islamic heritage reaches the bay through centuries of Ottoman-era ties.

Kotor is a fjord-like wonder at the southern edge of Europe—a walled Venetian town huddled at the end of a bay so dramatic it looks like Norway met the Mediterranean. Climb its fortress walls at dawn and you will understand why poets lose their words here.

20 Things to Do in Kotor

1. Climb the 1,350 steps up the city walls to the Fortress of San Giovanni—the view is Europe's finest.
2. Wander the marble lanes of the UNESCO-listed Old Town.
3. Visit St. Tryphon Cathedral, consecrated in 1166.
4. Take a boat across the bay to the island church of Our Lady of the Rocks.
5. Explore elegant Perast, the bay's baroque sea captains' village.
6. Ride the Kotor–Lovcen cable car for a staggering bird's-eye view of the bay.
7. Visit the Maritime Museum and learn the bay's seafaring story.
8. Walk the seaside promenade from Dobrota into town at sunset.
9. Kayak the calm morning waters of the bay.
10. Hike the Ladder of Kotor, the old switchback trail to Cetinje.
11. Swim from the little stone piers along the bay.
12. Take a speedboat to the Blue Cave for a glowing swim.
13. Feast on the bay's famous seafood—grilled calamari, black risotto, and mussels, all halal-friendly.
14. Browse the cats' museum and meet Kotor's famous feline residents.
15. See the Roman mosaics of Risan, the bay's oldest town.
16. Drive the serpentine road to Lovcen National Park and Njegos's mausoleum.
17. Explore the old Austro-Hungarian submarine pens hidden in the coast.
18. Day-trip to Lake Skadar for boat rides and birdwatching.
19. Photograph the orange rooftops from the fortress at golden hour.
20. Enjoy a quiet evening on a palace-square terrace as the bay turns silver.

Budva, Montenegro

Halal food is easy to find in Budva — seafood and grills abound — and Islamic culture is part of the Montenegrin story, with historic masjids in the nearby coastal towns of Bar and Ulcinj.

Budva is Montenegro's Riviera—a tiny walled old town of Venetian stone ringed by some of the Adriatic's best beaches, with the fairy-tale islet of Sveti Stefan just down the coast. It is the sunniest, liveliest spot on the Montenegrin shore.

20 Things to Do in Budva

1. Wander the Stari Grad, Budva's walled old town of stone lanes and churches.
2. Sunbathe and swim at Mogren Beach, reached by a cliffside path.
3. Photograph the iconic islet of Sveti Stefan from the viewpoints.
4. Spend a day at Jaz Beach, one of the Adriatic's longest and loveliest.
5. Take a boat to Sveti Nikola island for quiet beaches facing the town.
6. Walk the walls and citadel for views over the terracotta roofs.
7. Stroll the marina and the long seafront promenade at dusk.
8. Swim in the clear coves of Becici and Rafailovici.
9. Visit the Budva City Museum and the old town's little galleries.
10. Pose with the famous ballerina statue on the rocks.
11. Splash at Aquapark Budva in the hills above town.
12. Take a day trip to Kotor and the inner bay.
13. Day-trip to Cetinje, the old royal capital in the mountains.
14. Day-trip to Lake Skadar National Park.
15. Feast on fresh Adriatic fish and seafood risotto at the harbour konobas—an easy halal choice.
16. Try paragliding from the Brajici hills down to the sea.
17. Visit the Podmaine Monastery and its peaceful gardens.
18. Dance-free evening alternative: a moonlit walk along the full length of the promenade.
19. Watch the fishing boats come in at the old harbour at dawn.
20. Simply slow down to Adriatic time—coffee, sea, repeat.

Podgorica, Montenegro

Halal food is easy to find in Podgorica, home to a vibrant Muslim community whose historic masjids grace the old Ottoman quarter of Stara Varoš.

Podgorica is Montenegro's understated capital—a green city of rivers, bridges, and hills, where Ottoman masajid stand near Orthodox cathedrals and the great Lake Skadar lies at its doorstep. It is the relaxed base from which the whole country unfolds.

20 Things to Do in Podgorica

1. Cross the Millennium Bridge, the symbol of the modern city.
2. Explore Stara Varos, the old Ottoman quarter, with its clock tower and historic masajid.

3. Visit the Starodoganjska and Osmanagica masajid, reminders of Montenegro's deep Muslim heritage.
4. Admire the vast mosaics of the Cathedral of the Resurrection of Christ.
5. See the old stone bridge over the Ribnica where it meets the Moraca.
6. Drive to the Niagara Falls of Montenegro on the Cijevna river.
7. Take a day trip to Lake Skadar—boat rides, pelicans, and lily-covered water.
8. Explore the riverside village of Virpazar and its stone bridge.
9. Hike up Gorica hill, the green lung that gave the city its name.
10. Visit the ancient Roman ruins of Doclea (Duklja) at the city's edge.
11. Drive the breathtaking Moraca River Canyon toward the mountains.
12. Visit the cave monastery of Dajbabe, carved into living rock.
13. Day-trip to Cetinje, the historic royal capital, and the Njegusi valley.
14. Sample Montenegrin cuisine—lamb, fresh trout, and pastries; halal restaurants are easy to find thanks to the city's large Muslim community.
15. Browse the stalls of the city markets for mountain cheese and honey.
16. Walk the shady boulevards and parks of the compact centre.
17. Visit the Natural History Museum and the city's small galleries.
18. Take the spectacular train ride toward the mountains—one of Europe's great rail journeys.
19. Watch sunset from the Ljubovic hill viewpoint.
20. Use Podgorica as your base: nowhere in Montenegro is more than two hours away.

Mostar, Bosnia and Herzegovina

Halal food is available everywhere in Mostar, and Islamic culture is the city's very soul — Ottoman masjids, bazaars, and the sacred rhythm of the Neretva's banks.

Mostar is a poem in stone—the graceful arc of Stari Most leaping over the emerald Neretva, rebuilt from ruin as a symbol of hope. Its cobbled bazaar, masjid minarets, and diving brave men make it the most evocative small city in the Balkans.

20 Things to Do in Mostar

1. Stand on Stari Most, the famous Old Bridge, and watch the divers leap into the Neretva.
2. Climb the minaret of the Koski Mehmed Pasha Masjid for the classic bridge view.
3. Wander the copper-scented Old Bazaar, the Kujundziluk.
4. Visit the Biscevica and Kajtaz Turkish Houses, preserved Ottoman homes.
5. Cross the crooked little Kriva Cuprija bridge, the bridge's miniature twin.
6. Visit the moving Museum of War and Genocide Victims to understand the city's recent past.

7. Take a day trip to Blagaj, where a 16th-century dervish tekke sits beside the mighty Buna spring.
8. Swim and picnic at the emerald Kravice Waterfalls.
9. Explore the medieval stone village of Pocitelj on the Neretva.
10. Learn the bridge's story at the Old Bridge Museum in Tara Tower.
11. Feast on Bosnian specialties—cevapi, begova corba, and baklava; Mostar is a halal food haven.
12. Drink Bosnian coffee poured the traditional way, with rahat lokum.
13. Photograph the bridge at dusk when the crowds melt away.
14. Visit the Karadoz-beg Masjid, one of the most beautiful in Herzegovina.
15. Walk the banks of the Neretva and watch the light change on the water.
16. Browse the bazaar's coppersmiths at work on trays and coffee sets.
17. Take a day trip into the mountains for rafting on the Neretva.
18. Visit the Partisan Memorial Cemetery, a masterpiece of Yugoslav-era architecture.
19. Watch a bridge-jumping show and applaud the divers' courage.
20. Return after dark, when the bridge is lit and Mostar feels like a fairy tale.

Sarajevo, Bosnia and Herzegovina

Halal food is available everywhere in Sarajevo, the Jerusalem of Europe — a city where Islamic culture has flourished for over five centuries, with masjids on every street.

Sarajevo is the Jerusalem of Europe—where masajid, churches, and synagogues share the same streets, where the Ottoman East meets the Austro-Hungarian West on a single corner. Heartbreakingly resilient and endlessly warm, it is one of Europe's most soulful capitals—and one of its most Muslim-friendly.

20 Things to Do in Sarajevo

1. Wander Bascarsija, the 15th-century Ottoman bazaar quarter.
2. Feed the pigeons at the Sebilj, the beloved wooden fountain.
3. Visit the Gazi Husrev-beg Masjid, the spiritual heart of Bosnian Islam since 1531.
4. Stand at the Latin Bridge, where the shot that started World War I was fired.
5. Tour the Tunnel of Hope, the lifeline of the besieged city.
6. Ride the cable car up Mount Trebevic for views and Olympic ruins.
7. Watch the sunset from the Yellow Fortress as prayers echo up from the valley.
8. Feast on cevapi in somun bread—Bosnia's pride, halal by tradition.
9. Try burek and other pita pies from a hole-in-the-wall pekara.
10. Drink Bosnian coffee slowly—it is a ceremony, not a beverage.
11. Visit the beautifully restored City Hall (Vijecnica), a Moorish-revival masterpiece.

12. See the Eternal Flame and walk the Austro-Hungarian Ferhadija street.
13. Visit Galerija 11/07/95, the moving memorial to Srebrenica.
14. Explore the Morica Han, the last great Ottoman caravanserai in the city.
15. Visit the Svrzo House, a perfectly preserved Ottoman family home.
16. Take a day trip to Vrelo Bosne, the spring of the river Bosna, by horse-drawn carriage.
17. Hike or ski the Olympic mountains of Bjelasnica and Igman.
18. Look for the Sarajevo Roses—mortar scars filled with red resin—across the pavements.
19. View the city from the Avaz Twist Tower's observation deck.
20. Talk to people—Sarajevo's greatest treasure is its warmth.

Ohrid, North Macedonia

Halal food is easy to find in Ohrid, whose Muslim community and historic masjids have been part of the lake city's fabric for centuries.

Ohrid is the Balkans' sacred lake city—an ancient UNESCO jewel where 365 churches once stood, Byzantine frescoes glow in clifftop chapels, and the water of one of Europe's oldest lakes is impossibly clear. Peaceful, affordable, and profoundly beautiful.

20 Things to Do in Ohrid

1. Visit the Church of St. John at Kaneo, perched on a cliff above the lake—the Balkans' most famous view.
2. Walk the walls of Tsar Samuil's Fortress above the old town.
3. Swim in the crystal waters of Lake Ohrid, one of the oldest and deepest lakes in the world.
4. Take a boat to the Monastery of Sveti Naum and its peacock-filled springs.
5. Explore the ancient theatre, still hosting summer performances.
6. See the frescoes and mosaics at Plaosnik and the Church of St. Clement.
7. Visit the Church of St. Sophia and its medieval masterpieces.
8. Wander the bazaar street of the old town (Carsija).
9. Visit the Bay of Bones, a reconstructed prehistoric stilt village.
10. Hike in Galicica National Park between lakes Ohrid and Prespa.
11. Take a sunset boat cruise on the lake.
12. Visit the Robevci House, a grand Ottoman-era merchant's home turned museum.
13. Taste lake trout and local grills at the waterfront restaurants; halal options are easy to find in this city with a significant Muslim community.
14. Visit the Ali Pasha Masjid and the old hammam quarter.
15. Shop for famous Ohrid pearls and filigree silver.
16. Swim at the hidden beaches of Ljubanista and Trpejca.

17. Day-trip to Struga, where the river Drim flows out of the lake.
18. Visit the springs of the Black Drim by boat from Sveti Naum.
19. Photograph the old town's stacked red roofs from the fortress at sunset.
20. Attend a summer evening of the Ohrid Summer Festival in the ancient theatre.

Skopje, North Macedonia

Halal food is easy to find in Skopje, home to one of the Balkans' great Muslim communities — Ottoman masjids and a 600-year-old bazaar anchor its Islamic heritage.

Skopje is the Balkans' most surprising capital—a city where a vast Ottoman bazaar faces a square of neoclassical grandeur across a 15th-century stone bridge, with a fortress, a canyon, and a mountain cross all within city limits. Muslim-friendly to its core.

20 Things to Do in Skopje

1. Wander the Old Bazaar, one of the largest and oldest in the Balkans, still fragrant with spices and copper.
2. Cross the Stone Bridge into Macedonia Square and its grand monuments.
3. Visit the Mustafa Pasha Masjid, an Ottoman masterpiece above the bazaar.
4. Explore the Kale Fortress, guarding the city since Byzantine times.
5. Visit the memorial house of Mother Teresa, born in Skopje.
6. Day-trip to Matka Canyon—boat or kayak to the Vrelo Cave.
7. Ride the cable car up Mount Vodno to the towering Millennium Cross.
8. See the breathtaking carved iconostasis of the Church of St. Spas.
9. Explore the Daut Pasha Hamam, now the National Gallery.
10. Walk through the Kursumli An, the old caravanserai of the bazaar.
11. Feast in the Debar Maalo district, the bohemian quarter of grill houses; halal options abound thanks to the city's large Muslim community.
12. Browse Bit Pazar, the vast and colourful green market.
13. Visit the Museum of Macedonia for the nation's story.
14. Admire the Cifte Hamam and the bazaar's many Ottoman inns.
15. Hike the trails of Mount Vodno through the forest.
16. See the Skopje Aqueduct, a Roman-era mystery on the city's edge.
17. Visit the Museum of Contemporary Art on its hill above the centre.
18. Sip thick Turkish-style coffee in a bazaar courtyard.
19. Try tavce gravce and ajvar, the beloved national dishes.
20. Watch the bridge and square light up at night from the fortress walls.

Tetovo, North Macedonia

Halal food is available everywhere in Tetovo, a majority-Muslim city where Islamic culture glows — home to the Painted Masjid, the most beautiful in the Balkans.

Tetovo is North Macedonia's hidden gem—a majority-Muslim city beneath the towering Sar Mountains, home to the most beautiful painted masjid in the Balkans and a serene Bektashi dervish complex. Few tourists come, which is exactly why you should.

20 Things to Do in Tetovo

1. Marvel at the Sarena Dzamija, the Painted Masjid—every inch covered in luminous floral art.
2. Visit the Arabati Baba Tekke, the serene Bektashi dervish lodge with its flower-filled courtyards.
3. Ride or hike up to Popova Sapka, the Sar Mountain ski resort, for skiing in winter and meadows in summer.
4. Explore the ruins of the Baltepe Fortress above the town.
5. Browse the bustling central bazaar and green market.
6. Feast on the city's famous grilled meats, burek, and flija—Tetovo is a halal food capital of the region.
7. Hike the trails of Sar Mountain National Park among glacial lakes.
8. Visit the traditional mountain villages, such as Vesala and Bozovce, clinging to the slopes.
9. Taste Sar Mountain cheese and kaymak at village farms.
10. Visit the Leshok Monastery complex with its frescoed churches.
11. Drive the dramatic gorge of the Radika River.
12. Day-trip to Mavrovo National Park and its drowned church lake.
13. Explore the Tetovo Museum in the old town.
14. Enjoy the café culture along the pedestrianised centre.
15. Visit the Ottoman-era stone bridges and old hammam buildings.
16. Shop for mountain honey, herbs, and hand-knotted wool rugs.
17. Take a day trip to Prizren in Kosovo, just over the mountains.
18. Experience Friday prayers at the Painted Masjid—a memory for life.
19. Photograph the minarets against the snow-capped Sar range at sunset.
20. Enjoy the warmth of Albanian-Macedonian hospitality over mountain tea.

Tirana, Albania

Halal food is available everywhere in Tirana, the capital of majority-Muslim Albania — home to the Balkans' largest masjid and a warm Islamic heritage reborn.

Tirana is the comeback kid of European capitals—once grey and closed, now an explosion of colour, cafés, and confidence. With its grand new masjid, Cold War bunkers turned museums, a cable car up Mount Dajti, and some of Europe's friendliest people, it rewards the curious at every turn.

20 Things to Do in Tirana

1. Start at Skanderbeg Square, the vast heart of the city.
2. Visit the Et'hem Bey Masjid, an 18th-century jewel of painted prayer halls.
3. Tour the Great Masjid of Tirana (Namazgja), the largest masjid in the Balkans.
4. Descend into Bunk'Art 1 and 2—vast Cold War bunkers turned haunting museums.
5. Climb the Pyramid of Tirana, reborn as a public viewpoint.
6. Ride the Dajti Ekspres cable car up Mount Dajti for lunch above the clouds.
7. Explore the National History Museum and its giant mosaic facade.
8. Stroll and dine in Blloku, once the forbidden communist quarter, now the lively café district.
9. Browse the New Bazaar (Pazari i Ri) for produce, raki-free souvenirs, and snacks.
10. Visit the Resurrection of Christ Orthodox Cathedral, among Europe's largest.
11. Walk the Grand Park and its lake, the city's green heart.
12. Visit the House of Leaves, the chilling museum of communist surveillance.
13. Cross the stone Tanners' Bridge, a relic of Ottoman Tirana.
14. Feast on byrek, tave kosi, and grilled qofte—Albania is majority Muslim and halal food is everywhere.
15. Day-trip to Kruje, Skanderbeg's mountain stronghold, with its castle and bazaar.
16. Day-trip to Durres for Roman ruins and beach time.
17. Hike the Dajti trails through beech forest.
18. Sip some of Europe's best-value coffee—Tirana runs on espresso and macchiatos.
19. Visit the Tirana Castle complex, now a lively courtyard of shops and eateries.
20. Watch the city glow from a rooftop at sunset, minarets and mountains on the skyline.

Prizren, Kosovo

Halal food is available everywhere in Prizren, Kosovo's Ottoman jewel — masjids, tekkes, and halal kitchens fill this overwhelmingly Muslim town.

Prizren is the prettiest town in Kosovo—an Ottoman gem of masajid, bridges, and stone lanes gathered under a hilltop fortress, with the Lumbardhi river running through its heart. If the Balkans has a hidden treasure chest, Prizren is it.

20 Things to Do in Prizren

1. Climb to Prizren Fortress for sunset over a sea of minarets and red roofs.
2. Visit the Sinan Pasha Masjid, the city's elegant landmark.
3. Cross the old Stone Bridge over the Lumbardhi river.
4. Stroll Shadervan Square, the town's lively fountain heart.
5. Explore the restored Gazi Mehmet Pasha Hammam.
6. Visit the Albanian League of Prizren Museum, birthplace of a nation's movement.
7. See the medieval frescoes of Our Lady of Ljevis, a UNESCO World Heritage church.
8. Visit the Halveti Tekke, a living dervish lodge of the Halveti order.
9. Feast in the town that calls itself Kosovo's culinary capital—qebapa, flija, and baklava, all halal in this overwhelmingly Muslim town.
10. Walk the riverside promenade at dusk when the masajid light up.
11. Browse the filigree silver workshops, Prizren's signature craft.
12. Visit the Orthodox and Catholic landmarks of this multi-faith town.
13. Attend Dokufest in August, the beloved documentary film festival.
14. Take a day trip to the Mirusha Waterfalls and their blue pools.
15. Day-trip over the mountains to the ski resort of Brezovica.
16. Hike the fortress trail at sunrise for empty views.
17. Relax in Marash Park under ancient plane trees.
18. Drink macchiato like a local—Kosovo takes coffee very seriously.
19. Photograph the old town from the fortress as the call to prayer rises.
20. Wander without a map—every lane of Prizren rewards the wanderer.

Pristina, Kosovo

Halal food is available everywhere in Pristina, Europe's youngest and most welcoming Muslim-majority capital — masjids and halal grill houses line every street.

Pristina is Europe's youngest capital—raw, optimistic, and caffeinated like nowhere else. It wears its history openly: Ottoman masajid, Yugoslav-era brutalism, the Newborn sign repainted every year, and the friendliest welcome on the continent.

20 Things to Do in Pristina

1. See the NEWBORN monument, unveiled at independence and repainted annually.
2. Visit the extraordinary National Library, a brutalist icon wrapped in a steel net.
3. Climb the bell tower of the Mother Teresa Cathedral for the city panorama.
4. Visit the Imperial Masjid, built by Sultan Mehmed the Conqueror in 1461.

5. Explore the Ethnological Museum in the beautiful Ottoman Emin Gjiku complex.
6. Walk Mother Teresa Boulevard, the pedestrian spine of the city.
7. Find the Bill Clinton statue and boulevard—Kosovo's affection for America is real.
8. Visit the Kosovo Museum for archaeology, including the Goddess on the Throne.
9. Feast in the city's grill houses—Pristina is a halal dining paradise, from qebapa to sutlijas desserts.
10. Drink what many call the world's best macchiato in the city's endless cafés.
11. Escape to Gërmia Park, the forested hills at the city's edge.
12. Take a day trip to the Bear Sanctuary near Mramor.
13. Explore the ruins of Ulpiana, the Roman city just outside the capital.
14. Visit the UNESCO-listed Gracanica Monastery on a day trip.
15. Browse the green market and old bazaar quarter.
16. Visit the grand Carshi Masjid in the heart of old Pristina.
17. Day-trip to the Gadime Cave with its marble halls.
18. Take a day trip west to Peja and the spectacular Rugova Gorge.
19. Experience the nightlife-free alternative: a late evening of cakes, coffee, and conversation on the boulevard.
20. Attend the Sunny Hill Festival in summer, founded by hometown star Dua Lipa.

NORTH AFRICA

Marrakesh, Morocco

Halal food is available everywhere in Marrakesh, and Islamic culture has crowned the Red City for a thousand years — masjids, madrasas, and the minaret of the Koutoubia.

Marrakesh is the Red City—a thousand years of sultans, souks, and storytellers beneath the snow line of the Atlas. Its medina overwhelms every sense at once: drumbeats, mint tea, saffron, and leather, all swirling around the great square of Jemaa el-Fnaa. There is nowhere else like it.

20 Things to Do in Marrakesh

1. Experience Jemaa el-Fnaa at dusk—storytellers, drummers, and a hundred grill stalls.
2. Admire the Koutoubia Masjid, the city's elegant 12th-century landmark.
3. Get happily lost in the souks—lanterns, carpets, leather, and spices.
4. Wander the Bahia Palace and its painted cedar ceilings.
5. Visit the Saadian Tombs, hidden for centuries and rediscovered in 1917.
6. Be dazzled by the Ben Youssef Madrasa, Morocco's most beautiful Quranic college.
7. Stroll the cobalt-blue lanes of the Jardin Majorelle and visit the Yves Saint Laurent Museum.
8. Take a horse-drawn caleche ride around the ramparts at sunset.
9. Visit the ruined grandeur of El Badi Palace.
10. Relax in Le Jardin Secret, the medina's hidden riad garden.
11. Experience a traditional hammam—scrub, steam, and serenity.
12. Feast on tagine, couscous, and grilled meats—everything in Morocco is halal by default.
13. Take a Moroccan cooking class and shop the spice souks for your ingredients.
14. Day-trip to the Atlas Mountains and the Ourika Valley's waterfalls.
15. Ride camels and watch the sunset in the rocky Agafay Desert.
16. See the Koutoubia's reflection in the Menara Gardens' great pool.
17. Explore the Mellah, the old Jewish quarter, and its spice market.
18. Watch artisans at work in the dyers' and tanners' souks.
19. Take a hot air balloon ride over the palm groves at dawn.
20. Sip mint tea on a rooftop as the Atlas Mountains turn purple at dusk.

Essaouira, Morocco

Halal food is available everywhere in Essaouira, and Islamic culture drifts through the Atlantic medina with the scent of the sea and the sound of the muezzin.

Essaouira is Morocco's breezy seaside soul—a whitewashed Atlantic medina where blue boats bob in the harbour, seagulls wheel over 18th-century ramparts, and the wind is a permanent guest. Artists, surfers, and Gnawa musicians have all fallen for its spell.

20 Things to Do in Essaouira

1. Walk the UNESCO-listed medina, the most relaxed in Morocco.
2. Stroll the Skala de la Ville ramparts as waves crash against the cannons.
3. Watch the blue fishing boats unload at the port.
4. Eat grilled sardines and calamari at the port's open-air stands—fresh, cheap, and halal.
5. Try windsurfing or kitesurfing in the windy bay.
6. Ride a camel or horse along the endless beach at sunset.
7. Browse the art galleries and thuya-wood workshops of the medina.
8. Visit the Sidi Mohammed ben Abdallah Museum of local history.
9. Explore the Sqala du Port, the harbour fortress seen in Game of Thrones.
10. Visit an argan oil cooperative and see how Morocco's liquid gold is made.
11. Look for the famous tree-climbing goats on the road to Marrakesh.
12. Listen for Gnawa music drifting through the medina—visit during the June festival if you can.
13. Wander the old Mellah and learn Essaouira's Jewish-Muslim shared heritage.
14. Shop for carpets, ceramics, and jewellery at gentler prices than Marrakesh.
15. Take a surf lesson on the gentle beach breaks.
16. Walk to the ruined Borj el Berod watchtower at low tide.
17. Enjoy seafood tagine on a terrace overlooking the Atlantic.
18. Visit the nearby village of Diabat and its windswept dunes.
19. Relax in a hammam after a day in the salt air.
20. Watch the sunset turn the ramparts gold as the day's last gulls wheel overhead.

Tangier, Morocco

Halal food is available everywhere in Tangier, and Islamic culture guards the door of Africa — birthplace of Ibn Battuta and a city of ancient masjids.

Tangier is the door of Africa—where the Mediterranean meets the Atlantic and Europe shimmers across the Strait of Gibraltar. Beloved of writers, spies, and sultans, and birthplace of the great traveler Ibn Battuta, it mixes faded

international glamour with Moroccan soul.

20 Things to Do in Tangier

1. Explore the Kasbah and its museum in the former sultan's palace.
2. Wander the white lanes of the medina down to the sea.
3. Sip mint tea at the legendary Cafe Hafa, clinging to the cliffs since 1921.
4. Stand at Cap Spartel, where the Mediterranean meets the Atlantic.
5. Visit the Caves of Hercules and their famous Africa-shaped opening to the sea.
6. Tour the American Legation, the only US National Historic Landmark abroad.
7. Gaze across to Spain from the Grand Socco and the Kasbah walls.
8. Visit the tomb of Ibn Battuta, history's greatest traveler, in the medina.
9. Stroll the corniche and the beaches of the bay.
10. Browse the Petit Socco, once the haunt of writers and diplomats.
11. Visit the Grand Masjid of Tangier and the Mendoubia Gardens' great banyan trees.
12. See St. Andrew's Church, a touching symbol of Tangier's multifaith past, with the Lord's Prayer in Arabic.
13. Take a day trip to Chefchaouen, the famous blue city in the Rif Mountains.
14. Day-trip to Asilah, the whitewashed artists' town on the Atlantic.
15. Haggle for textiles and ceramics in the medina souks.
16. Enjoy fresh fish tagine at the port restaurants—all halal, all delicious.
17. Walk the new marina and corniche at dusk with local families.
18. Visit Parc Perdicaris and its clifftop forest.
19. Trace the footsteps of Paul Bowles and the Beat writers.
20. Watch the ferries slide across the strait as Tangier's lights come on.

Rabat, Morocco

Halal food is available everywhere in Rabat, and Islamic culture defines the capital — from the Hassan Tower's minaret to the blue lanes of the Kasbah.

Rabat is Morocco's serene capital—elegant, green, and often skipped, which is its charm. A kasbah of blue-and-white lanes above the Atlantic, an unfinished medieval minaret, and bougainvillea-draped gardens make it the kingdom's most graceful city.

20 Things to Do in Rabat

1. Stand before the Hassan Tower, the unfinished 12th-century minaret, and its forest of columns.
2. Visit the gleaming Mausoleum of Mohammed V, guarded by royal horsemen.
3. Get lost in the Kasbah of the Udayas' blue-and-white lanes.
4. Sip mint tea at Cafe Maure overlooking the river mouth.

5. Wander the haunting ruins and gardens of the Chellah necropolis.
6. Explore the Andalusian Gardens beneath the kasbah walls.
7. Walk the Bouregreg riverfront and the new marina.
8. Visit the Mohammed VI Museum of Modern and Contemporary Art.
9. Surf or stroll at Rabat's Atlantic beaches.
10. See the Royal Palace from its grand parade square.
11. Cross the river by rowboat to the old pirate city of Sale.
12. Browse the medina's carpet and craft souks—calmer than Marrakesh.
13. Visit the Archaeology Museum and its Roman treasures.
14. Admire the Mohammed VI Tower, Africa's tallest skyscraper, from the riverbank.
15. Relax in the Jardin d'Essais, the city's botanical garden.
16. Feast on Moroccan classics—tagine, pastilla, and harira—every morsel halal.
17. Ride the sleek tram between Rabat and Sale like a local.
18. Walk the vast ocean-facing walls of the old city.
19. Day-trip to Meknes and the Roman ruins of Volubilis.
20. Watch the sunset from the kasbah walls as the Atlantic turns to fire.

Casablanca, Morocco

Halal food is available everywhere in Casablanca, and Islamic culture reaches its peak at the Hassan II Masjid — one of the greatest houses of worship on earth.

Casablanca is Morocco's beating commercial heart—a city of art deco boulevards, Atlantic waves, and one astonishing masjid that seems to float on the ocean. It is grittier than the tourist trail but rewards those who look closer.

20 Things to Do in Casablanca

1. Tour the Hassan II Masjid—one of the largest in the world, with a retractable roof and glass floor above the sea; one of the few masajid in Morocco open to non-worshipper visitors on guided tours.
2. Walk the Corniche at Ain Diab along the Atlantic.
3. Explore the Habous Quarter, the charming "new medina" of the 1930s.
4. Wander the old medina's raw, real lanes near the port.
5. Have coffee at Rick's Cafe, a loving recreation of the film's famous gin joint.
6. Browse the Central Market for seafood and flowers.
7. Dine at La Sqala, a garden restaurant inside an 18th-century bastion.
8. Visit the Museum of Moroccan Judaism—the only Jewish museum in the Arab world.
9. Admire the art deco and Moorish-revival facades of the city centre.
10. See the golden mosaics of the Sacre-Coeur Cathedral, now a cultural centre.
11. Visit the Villa des Arts for contemporary Moroccan art.

12. Shop and watch the musical fountain at the Morocco Mall.
13. Relax in the Arab League Park's palm avenues.
14. Enjoy grilled fish at the port-side stalls—halal and straight off the boats.
15. Ride the tram through the city's contrasting neighbourhoods.
16. Visit the El Hank lighthouse and the rocky coast beyond.
17. Take the kids to Sindibad Park by the sea.
18. Day-trip to El Jadida, the UNESCO-listed Portuguese coastal city.
19. Watch the sunset from the Hassan II Masjid esplanade as the waves crash below.
20. Experience Friday prayers near the great masjid—a sea of worshippers you will never forget.

Cairo, Egypt

Halal food is available everywhere in Cairo, the City of a Thousand Minarets — the beating heart of Islamic civilization for over a thousand years, and home to Al-Azhar.

Cairo is the Mother of the World—five thousand years of history piled into one vast, chaotic, magnificent metropolis. The Pyramids at dawn, the medieval minarets of Islamic Cairo at dusk, the Nile sliding through it all: no city on earth layers time like this.

20 Things to Do in Cairo

1. Stand before the Pyramids of Giza and the Sphinx—the last ancient Wonder of the World.
2. Visit the Grand Egyptian Museum, the world's largest museum of a single civilisation, beside the pyramids.
3. Explore the treasures of the Egyptian Museum on Tahrir Square.
4. Haggle in Khan el-Khalili, the great medieval bazaar.
5. Walk Al-Muizz Street, an open-air museum of Islamic architecture.
6. Visit the Citadel of Saladin and the alabaster Masjid of Muhammad Ali.
7. Admire the masajid of Sultan Hassan and Al-Rifa'i, facing each other across history.
8. Pray or reflect at Al-Azhar Masjid, seat of the world's oldest university.
9. Climb the minaret of Bab Zuweila for the best view of Islamic Cairo.
10. Descend into Coptic Cairo—the Hanging Church and the ancient alleys of old Christianity.
11. Visit the Masjid of Ibn Tulun, Cairo's oldest intact masjid, and the Gayer-Anderson Museum beside it.
12. Sail a felucca on the Nile at sunset.
13. View the endless city from the Cairo Tower.
14. Feast on koshary, Egypt's beloved street dish—filling, cheap, and halal.
15. Watch the Tanoura whirling show at Wekalet El Ghouri.

16. Take a day trip to Saqqara's Step Pyramid and ancient Memphis.
17. Relax in Al-Azhar Park, a green miracle above the old city, with sunset views.
18. Stroll the island of Zamalek and its cafes and galleries.
19. Try Egypt's sweets—kunafa, basbousa, and fresh sugarcane juice.
20. Watch the Sound and Light Show at the pyramids under the stars.

Alexandria, Egypt

Halal food is available everywhere in Alexandria, and Islamic culture graces the Mediterranean bride — historic masjids stand where the Pharos once shone.

Alexandria is the Mediterranean's faded queen—the city of Alexander and Cleopatra, of the Great Library and the Pharos lighthouse, now a breezy corniche city of seafood, trams, and sea air. Egyptians call it the Bride of the Mediterranean, and she still charms.

20 Things to Do in Alexandria

1. Visit the Bibliotheca Alexandrina, the stunning modern rebirth of the ancient Great Library.
2. Explore the Citadel of Qaitbay, standing where the Pharos lighthouse once shone.
3. Walk the long Corniche from the harbour to Montaza.
4. Wander the gardens and beaches of the Montaza Palace grounds.
5. Visit the Abu al-Abbas al-Mursi Masjid, the city's most beautiful, near the harbour.
6. Descend into the Catacombs of Kom el-Shoqafa, a wonder of the ancient world.
7. See Pompey's Pillar towering over the ruins of the Serapeum.
8. Explore the Roman Theatre and its marble seating.
9. Visit the Alexandria National Museum in an Italianate palace.
10. Feast on the Mediterranean's best seafood at the Anfushi fish quarter—halal and unforgettable.
11. Photograph Stanley Bridge and its crescent bay.
12. Ride the rumbling blue trams, among the world's oldest.
13. Visit the Graeco-Roman Museum, newly restored.
14. Tour the Royal Jewelry Museum in a Zizinia palace.
15. Have tea and cake at the grand old cafes—Delices and Trianon have served writers for a century.
16. Take a day trip to Rosetta (Rashid), where the famous stone was found, with its Ottoman houses and delta views.
17. Visit the El Alamein war memorials on a day trip west.
18. Stroll the harbour at dawn as the fishing fleet comes in.
19. Watch sunset from the Qaitbay walls with the Mediterranean wind in your face.

20. Simply breathe the sea air that has refreshed travelers for 2,300 years.

Sharm El Sheikh, Egypt

Halal food is available everywhere in Sharm El Sheikh, and Islamic culture welcomes you — the Old Market's magnificent masjids rise above the Red Sea resorts.

Sharm El Sheikh is the Red Sea's diving capital—where desert mountains plunge into coral gardens teeming with life, and every hotel pool is a rehearsal for the reef. Sun, sea, and Bedouin hospitality make it Egypt's favourite escape.

20 Things to Do in Sharm El Sheikh

1. Snorkel or dive Ras Mohammed National Park, one of the world's great marine reserves.

2. Take a boat trip to the reefs of Tiran Island.

3. Stroll and dine along Naama Bay's promenade.

4. Visit the stunning Al Sahaba Masjid in the Old Market—an architectural jewel open to respectful visitors.

5. Haggle in the Old Market (Sharm Old Town) for spices and souvenirs.

6. Spend an evening at Soho Square's fountains and ice rink.

7. Go on a desert safari—quad bikes, camels, and a Bedouin dinner under the stars.

8. Take the sunrise hike up Mount Sinai and visit St. Catherine's Monastery, one of the oldest on earth.

9. Day-trip to Dahab and snorkel the famous Blue Hole.

10. Learn to dive with a PADI course in the world's classroom.

11. Advanced divers: dive the SS Thistlegorm, the legendary WWII wreck.

12. Relax at Shark's Bay with a snorkel straight off the jetty.

13. Watch the sunset from the cliff-top Farsha Cafe, a labyrinth of lamps and carpets.

14. Take a glass-bottom boat trip if you prefer to stay dry.

15. Splash around at the resort water parks.

16. Visit the Colored Canyon's swirling rock walls on a desert day trip.

17. Try parasailing above the bay for a reef's-eye view.

18. Enjoy fresh grilled fish at the marina restaurants—all halal.

19. Take a night walk in the desert for unbelievable stargazing.

20. Simply float above a coral garden—the Red Sea does the rest.

Hurghada, Egypt

Halal food is available everywhere in Hurghada, and Islamic culture anchors the old town — the beautiful El Mina Masjid watches over the marina.

Hurghada is the Red Sea's family favourite—miles of sandy resorts, some of the easiest reef snorkeling on the planet, and the gateway to Luxor's ancient wonders. It is sunshine guaranteed, 365 days a year.

20 Things to Do in Hurghada

1. Take a boat trip to Giftun Island—Orange Bay and Paradise Island are postcard-perfect.
2. Snorkel the coral reefs just offshore; the fish come to you.
3. Dive the Red Sea's famous reefs and wrecks.
4. Relax at Mahmya, the chic island beach club.
5. Explore El Dahar, the old town, and its authentic souk.
6. Visit the beautiful El Mina Masjid at the marina.
7. Stroll the Hurghada Marina boulevard in the evening.
8. Take the family to the Hurghada Grand Aquarium.
9. Descend in the Sindbad submarine for a dry dive among the reefs.
10. Go on a desert safari—quads, camels, and Bedouin tea under the stars.
11. Take a day trip to Luxor: Karnak, the Valley of the Kings, and the Nile.
12. Look for dolphins on a Dolphin House boat trip.
13. Try kitesurfing and windsurfing in the reliable Red Sea wind.
14. Day-trip to El Gouna, the lagoon town of canals and cafes.
15. Splash at Makadi Water World, one of Egypt's biggest water parks.
16. Visit Sand City, the open-air sand sculpture museum.
17. Feast on fresh seafood—grilled sayadiyeh fish is the local pride, and halal everywhere.
18. Try a fishing trip or sunset cruise from the marina.
19. Ride a camel along the beach at sunset.
20. Unwind—Hurghada's job is to make you do absolutely nothing.

Tunis, Tunisia

Halal food is available everywhere in Tunis, and Islamic culture fills the UNESCO medina — 1,300 years of devotion centred on the great Zitouna Masjid.

Tunis is the Mediterranean's most underrated capital—a UNESCO medina of golden stone, the ruins of Carthage by the sea, and the blue-and-white dream village of Sidi Bou Said up the coast. French facades meet Ottoman soul in a city made for wandering.

20 Things to Do in Tunis

1. Get lost in the Medina of Tunis, a UNESCO labyrinth of souks, masajid, and palaces.
2. Visit the Zitouna Masjid courtyard, the spiritual heart of the city for 1,300 years.

3. Explore the Bardo Museum and its unmatched Roman mosaics.
4. Walk among the ruins of Carthage—Rome's greatest rival, overlooking the sea.
5. Fall in love with Sidi Bou Said, the blue-and-white clifftop village.
6. Stroll Avenue Habib Bourguiba, the city's grand Champs-Elysees.
7. Pass through Bab el Bhar, the gate where the medina meets the French city.
8. Browse the souks for chechia hats, ceramics, and jasmine.
9. Visit the palaces and museums of the medina, like Dar Ben Abdallah.
10. Feast on Tunisian cuisine—brik, couscous, ojja, and harissa; every kitchen is halal.
11. Take the TGM train along the coast to La Goulette for seafood by the port.
12. Relax in Belvedere Park, the city's green hill.
13. See the Cathedral of St. Vincent de Paul, a relic of the French era.
14. Day-trip to Dougga, North Africa's best-preserved Roman city, in golden countryside.
15. Visit the Tophet and ports of ancient Carthage.
16. Sip mint tea with pine nuts at the clifftop Cafe des Nattes in Sidi Bou Said.
17. Watch the sunset over the Bay of Tunis from Sidi Bou Said's lighthouse.
18. Browse the bookshops and patisseries of the Ville Nouvelle.
19. Take a day trip south to Kairouan, Islam's fourth-holiest city, and its Great Masjid.
20. Enjoy the evening promenade—Tunis at night is all families, ice cream, and sea air.

Djerba, Tunisia

Halal food is available everywhere in Djerba, and Islamic culture shapes the whole island — its whitewashed masjids are a UNESCO treasure of their own.

Djerba is the island of dreams—Homer's Land of the Lotus Eaters, a UNESCO-listed flatland of whitewashed masajid, palm groves, and flamingo lagoons, with one of the oldest Jewish communities on earth living beside its Muslim neighbours as it has for 2,000 years.

20 Things to Do in Djerba

1. Explore Houmt Souk, the island's capital, with its funduq inns and market lanes.
2. Visit El Ghriba Synagogue, one of the oldest in Africa—a moving symbol of coexistence.
3. Wander Djerbahood in Erriadh, a village turned open-air street-art museum.
4. Relax on the island's soft sand beaches along the northeast coast.
5. Visit Guellala, the pottery village, and climb its museum for the island panorama.
6. Tour the Borj el Kebir fortress above the harbour.

7. Discover the island's unique whitewashed masajid, like the fortress-masjid of Fadhloun—Djerba's entire island heritage is UNESCO-listed.
8. Visit the Lalla Hadria Museum of Islamic art in the Djerba Explore park.
9. Meet the crocodiles of the Djerba Explore lagoon.
10. Ride camels or horses along the beach at golden hour.
11. Take a boat trip to the Flamingo Island for grilled-fish lunches on the sand.
12. Try kitesurfing and paddleboarding in the shallow warm lagoon.
13. Watch fishermen mend octopus pots in the harbours.
14. Feast on Djerban seafood—couscous with octopus is the island's signature, and all of it halal.
15. Day-trip to the ksour—ancient granary fortresses—of Tataouine and the Star Wars filming sites.
16. Day-trip to Ksar Ghilane, the oasis hot spring at the edge of the Sahara.
17. Shop for hand-loomed textiles and palm baskets in the souk.
18. Cycle the island's quiet lanes through olive and palm groves.
19. Watch flamingos feeding in the lagoons at dawn.
20. Indulge in a thalasso spa treatment—the island is famous for them.

Sousse, Tunisia

Halal food is available everywhere in Sousse, and Islamic culture towers over the coast — the 8th-century Ribat and Great Masjid guard the UNESCO medina.

Sousse is Tunisia's golden coastal city—a UNESCO medina and mighty ribat fortress on one side, a long sandy beach and lively resort strip on the other. It is history and holiday in one easy, sunny package.

20 Things to Do in Sousse

1. Explore the Medina of Sousse, a UNESCO-listed maze of souks and ramparts.
2. Climb the Ribat, the 8th-century fortress-monastery, for the classic city view.
3. Visit the Great Masjid of Sousse, austere and beautiful since 851 AD.
4. Tour the Kasbah and its superb mosaic museum.
5. Walk the city walls where the medina meets the sea.
6. Relax on Boujaafar Beach, the long city strand.
7. Stroll the marina and gardens of Port El Kantaoui.
8. Visit the Dar Essid Museum, a preserved merchant's mansion.
9. Explore the little-known catacombs of the Good Shepherd.
10. Feast on fresh fish and Tunisian salads at the port—all halal and delicious.
11. Take a day trip to El Jem, the colossal Roman amphitheatre rising from the plain.
12. Day-trip to Monastir—its ribat, mausoleum, and marina.
13. Shop the medina for olive wood, ceramics, and leather.

14. Take a camel ride along the beach at sunset.
15. Cool off at the Aqua Palace water park in Port El Kantaoui.
16. Enjoy a round of golf or a marina dinner in El Kantaoui.
17. Day-trip to Kairouan, Islam's fourth-holiest city, and its great masjid and carpet souks.
18. Visit Friguia Park for a family day with animals.
19. Walk the corniche at dusk when the whole city comes out.
20. Watch the sunset from the Ribat tower as the medina's minarets glow.

CENTRAL ASIA

Samarkand, Uzbekistan

Halal food is available everywhere in Samarkand, and Islamic culture dazzles — the city of Imam al-Bukhari, turquoise madrasas, and Silk Road masjids.

Samarkand is the crown of the Silk Road—Alexander marvelled at it, Genghis Khan razed it, and Timur rebuilt it in blue-tiled glory. The Registan at sunset, with its three great madrasas glowing gold and turquoise, is one of the great sights of the Islamic world.

20 Things to Do in Samarkand

1. Stand in the Registan Square, the most magnificent public space in Central Asia.
2. Visit Gur-e Amir, the turquoise-domed tomb of Timur (Tamerlane).
3. Walk the sacred avenue of Shah-i-Zinda, a necropolis of dazzling tilework.
4. Marvel at the vast Bibi-Khanym Masjid, once among the largest in the Islamic world.
5. Explore the Ulugh Beg Observatory, where a sultan-astronomer mapped the stars.
6. Shop the Siyob Bazaar for non bread, dried fruits, and mountain honey.
7. Visit the Afrosiab Museum on the site of ancient Samarkand.
8. Stop at the Hazrat Khizr Masjid overlooking the old city.
9. Visit the memorial complex of Imam al-Bukhari, the great hadith scholar, an important pilgrimage site.
10. Watch mulberry paper being made by hand at the Meros workshop in Konigil.
11. See the mausoleum of the prophet Daniel, revered by three faiths.
12. Feast on plov, Samarkand's pride, cooked in giant kazans—halal and hearty.
13. Take a day trip to Shahrisabz, Timur's birthplace, another UNESCO treasure.
14. Watch the evening light show illuminate the Registan.
15. Visit a silk carpet workshop and see master weavers at their looms.
16. Sip green tea in a shaded chaikhana beside the bazaar.
17. Ride the Afrosiyob high-speed train—the Silk Road at 250 km/h.
18. Photograph the Registan at dawn before the crowds arrive.
19. Explore the old Jewish and Tatar quarters of this most cosmopolitan of cities.
20. Return to the Registan at night—some squares must be seen twice.

Bukhara, Uzbekistan

Halal food is available everywhere in Bukhara, the 'Pillar of Islam' — a holy city of a thousand years, where masjids and madrasas fill the old town.

Bukhara is the most complete medieval city in Central Asia—a living museum of minarets, madrasas, and domed bazaars, where the Kalyan Minaret has called the faithful for nearly 900 years. It was once called the "Pillar of Islam," and it still feels holy.

20 Things to Do in Bukhara

1. Stand before the Kalyan Minaret, the "Tower of Death" that even Genghis Khan spared.
2. Explore the Po-i-Kalyan complex: minaret, masjid, and madrasa in perfect harmony.
3. Tour the Ark Fortress, the royal citadel of the emirs.
4. Relax beside Lyabi Hauz, the ancient pool shaded by mulberry trees.
5. Photograph the four turquoise-turreted towers of Chor Minor.
6. Shop in the three great trading domes—silks, knives, and suzani embroidery.
7. Visit the Ismail Samani Mausoleum, a 1,000-year-old masterpiece of brickwork.
8. See the Chashma-Ayub spring, the "Well of Job."
9. Admire the Bolo Haouz Masjid with its forest of wooden columns.
10. Explore Sitorai Mokhi-Khosa, the summer palace of the last emir.
11. Wander the old Jewish quarter and hear Bukhara's multifaith story.
12. Feast on plov and shashlik at a chaikhana—everything halal in the "noble city."
13. Take a traditional hammam at the medieval Borzi Kord bathhouse.
14. Watch a folk and fashion show in the Nadir Divan-Beghi Madrasa courtyard.
15. Visit the Magoki-Attori Masjid, the city's oldest, built over earlier temples.
16. Tour the Fayzulla Khodjaev house-museum of a wealthy 19th-century merchant.
17. Day-trip to the Chor Bakr necropolis, the "city of the dead" in the steppe.
18. Try Bukhara's golden, sesame-topped non bread, stamped with patterns.
19. Watch the sunset light up the Kalon Minaret from a rooftop teahouse.
20. Simply sit by Lyabi Hauz at dusk—Bukhara's magic hour is like no other.

Tashkent, Uzbekistan

Halal food is available everywhere in Tashkent, and Islamic culture is proudly kept — home to the ancient Uthman Quran and gleaming modern masjids.

Tashkent is the Silk Road's modern hub—a leafy, earthquake-rebuilt capital where Soviet mosaics meet turquoise masajid, the metro is an art gallery, and the bazaar dome of Chorsu anchors it all. It is your gateway into Central Asia, and a pleasure in itself.

20 Things to Do in Tashkent

1. Visit the Khast Imam complex, home to the Uthman Quran—one of the oldest Qurans in existence.
2. Admire the white marble Minor Masjid on the riverbank.
3. Explore Chorsu Bazaar beneath its great blue dome—spices, bread, and silk.
4. Ride the Tashkent Metro, each station a work of Soviet-era art.
5. Walk Amir Timur Square beneath the conqueror's equestrian statue.
6. Relax in Independence (Mustaqillik) Square and its fountains.
7. Visit the Museum of Applied Arts in a beautifully tiled merchant's mansion.
8. Ascend the Tashkent TV Tower for a view to the mountains.
9. Feast at the Central Asian Plov Centre, where one ton of plov cooks daily in giant kazans—halal and legendary.
10. Attend a ballet or opera at the Alisher Navoi Theatre for a few dollars.
11. Stroll Sayilgoh, the "Broadway" pedestrian street of artists and musicians.
12. Enjoy Tashkent City Park's fountains and evening light shows.
13. Visit the State Museum of History for the Silk Road story.
14. Explore the Kukeldash Madrasa beside the bazaar.
15. Take a day trip to the Chimgan Mountains and Charvak Lake for hiking and fresh air.
16. Ride the Afrosiyob high-speed train to Samarkand or Bukhara.
17. Visit the Hazrati Imam Friday masjid and the old town's mahalla lanes.
18. Wander the Botanical Garden in spring blossom.
19. Shop for ikat silk, ceramics, and dried fruits to bring home.
20. Enjoy Tashkent's café culture—Central Asia's most cosmopolitan capital surprises at every corner.

Khiva, Uzbekistan

Halal food is available everywhere in Khiva, and Islamic culture is perfectly preserved — a walled museum-city of masjids, madrasas, and minarets.

Khiva is the Silk Road's fairy tale—a perfectly preserved walled city of sand-coloured minarets and madrasas that feels frozen in the 18th century. Within the walls of Itchan Kala, you don't visit history; you live inside it.

20 Things to Do in Khiva

1. Walk through the gates of Itchan Kala, the UNESCO-listed walled inner city.
2. Photograph the Kalta Minor, the fat, turquoise-tiled "unfinished minaret."
3. Explore the Kunya-Ark fortress, the khans' citadel within the walls.
4. Climb the Islam Khoja Minaret for sunset over the whole city.
5. Step into the Juma Masjid, its prayer hall held up by 213 ancient wooden columns.

6. Tour the Tosh Hovli Palace, the khan's glittering residence.
7. Visit the Pakhlavan Mahmud Mausoleum, resting place of the poet-wrestler saint.
8. Walk the complete city walls at golden hour.
9. Browse the madrasa workshops—woodcarving, silk, and carpets made before your eyes.
10. Try Khorezm specialties: green shivit oshi noodles and tuhum barak dumplings—unique and halal.
11. Watch traditional music and dance in the palace courtyards.
12. Visit the Allakuli Khan Madrasa and the old caravanserai bazaar.
13. See the city wake at dawn when you have the streets to yourself.
14. Ride a camel by the western gates for the classic photo.
15. Take a day trip to the desert fortresses—Ayaz Kala and Toprak Kala rising from the sands.
16. Venture further to the Aral Sea's ship graveyard at Moynaq for a sobering journey.
17. Visit the Nurullabai Palace and its quirky mix of East and West.
18. Watch the walls glow amber under floodlights after dark.
19. Buy a chapan robe or fur hat as the ultimate Silk Road souvenir.
20. Stay inside the walls—in Khiva, the night belongs to the travelers who linger.

Almaty, Kazakhstan

Halal food is available everywhere in Almaty, and Islamic culture thrives beneath the mountains — Central Asian masjids and halal bazaars fill the leafy city.

Almaty is Central Asia's most liveable city—a leafy, café-filled metropolis pressed against the snow-capped Tian Shan, where you can breakfast in a French-style café and be hiking an alpine valley by noon. Apples were born here, and the city still tastes sweet.

20 Things to Do in Almaty

1. Take a day trip to Big Almaty Lake, a turquoise jewel high in the mountains.
2. Skate at Medeu, the world's highest outdoor ice rink.
3. Ride the gondolas up to Shymbulak ski resort—ski in winter, hike in summer.
4. Ride the cable car to Kok-Tobe hill for city views and the famous Beatles monument.
5. Explore the Green Bazaar—mountains of dried fruit, kurt cheese, and horse sausage.
6. Visit the candy-coloured Zenkov Cathedral in Panfilov Park, built entirely of wood without nails.
7. Learn the nation's story at the Central State Museum.
8. Stroll the Arbat (Zhibek Zholy) pedestrian street.

9. Feast on beshbarmak, lagman, and manti—Kazakh cuisine is hearty and halal.
10. Watch the Sunkar falconry show, eagles and all.
11. Day-trip to Charyn Canyon, Kazakhstan's Grand Canyon.
12. Day-trip to the Kolsai Lakes and sunken forest of Kaindy.
13. Relax in First President's Park beneath the mountain backdrop.
14. Hike the Ile-Alatau foothills straight from the city edge.
15. Visit the Almaty Museum and the city's growing art galleries.
16. Soak in the hot springs of Alma-Arasan gorge.
17. Taste aport apples and Kazakh chocolate in autumn markets.
18. Ride the metro—Almaty's small, clean, and pleasantly ornate.
19. Enjoy the café and restaurant scene of the Dostyk and Abai avenues.
20. Watch the mountains turn pink at sunset from Kok-Tobe—the Almaty ritual.

Astana, Kazakhstan

Halal food is available everywhere in Astana, and Islamic culture stands monumental — home to Central Asia's largest masjids in a city of the future.

Astana is the futuristic capital that rose from the steppe—a skyline of pyramids, golden orbs, and tent-shaped malls dreamed up on a grand scale, home to some of the largest and most beautiful masajid in Central Asia. Bold, wind-swept, and unlike anywhere else.

20 Things to Do in Astana

1. Go up Bayterek Tower, the golden "Tree of Life," and place your hand in the president's golden palm print.
2. Visit the Hazret Sultan Masjid, the largest masjid in Central Asia—a white-marble wonder.
3. Pray or reflect at the vast Nur-Astana Masjid, with its golden domes.
4. Explore the Palace of Peace and Reconciliation, Norman Foster's glass pyramid.
5. Wander Khan Shatyr, the giant transparent tent with an indoor beach at its peak.
6. Visit the National Museum of Kazakhstan and its Golden Man.
7. Explore the Nur Alem sphere, the futuristic museum from Expo 2017.
8. Stroll the Nurzhol Boulevard from Bayterek to Khan Shatyr.
9. Walk the Ishim river embankment and its summer beach.
10. Visit the Ak Orda presidential palace square and Independence monument.
11. Feast on Kazakh cuisine—beshbarmak, kazy sausage, and baursak doughnuts; halal is the norm.
12. Take a day trip to Burabay, the "Kazakh Switzerland" of lakes and pine forests.

13. Visit the moving ALZHIR memorial museum to the Gulag's victims.
14. Watch the singing fountains on the river in summer evenings.
15. Attend a performance at the stunning Astana Opera.
16. Cross the Atyrau Bridge, shaped like a giant sturgeon.
17. Experience winter Astana—ice towns, skating, and a true steppe winter.
18. Shop and dine at the Mega Silk Way mall beneath Khan Shatyr's shadow.
19. Visit the National Art Gallery and the city's growing creative quarter.
20. Watch the sunset gild the golden towers of this twenty-first-century capital.

Turkistan, Kazakhstan

Halal food is available everywhere in Turkistan, the spiritual capital of the Turkic world — six centuries of pilgrimage to the shrine of Khoja Ahmed Yasawi.

Turkistan is the spiritual capital of the Turkic world—home to the breathtaking mausoleum of Khoja Ahmed Yasawi, the poet-saint whose Sufi teachings shaped a civilisation. Pilgrims have journeyed here for six centuries, and the city has blossomed into Kazakhstan's most sacred destination.

20 Things to Do in Turkistan

1. Visit the Mausoleum of Khoja Ahmed Yasawi, the UNESCO-listed masterpiece Timur built for the great Sufi saint.
2. Explore the Azret Sultan historical complex surrounding the mausoleum.
3. Descend into the Hilvet underground masjid, where Yasawi meditated in retreat.
4. Visit the restored Friday masjid and the ancient city walls.
5. See the mausoleum of Rabiya Sultan Begim, the Timurid princess.
6. Visit the Ukasha Ata well, sacred to pilgrims.
7. Stroll the Karavansaray complex—a modern Silk Road bazaar with canals, boats, and evening shows.
8. Witness kokpar and Kazakh horseback games in the ethno-village arena.
9. Take a day trip to the Arystan Bab Mausoleum, tomb of Yasawi's teacher.
10. Explore the haunting ruins of Sauran, a once-great Silk Road city.
11. Visit the Yasawi Museum to understand the Sufi heritage of the steppe.
12. Feast on Kazakh cuisine—plov, beshbarmak, and baursak—in the pilgrim restaurants; halal everywhere.
13. Watch the evening fountain and light shows at Karavansaray.
14. Shop for Sufi books, prayer beads, and Kazakh crafts in the bazaar.
15. Join the quiet flow of pilgrims—visiting Yasawi's shrine three times is said to equal a journey to Makkah in local tradition.
16. Take a short day trip to Shymkent, the lively southern capital.
17. Photograph the mausoleum's turquoise dome at dawn and dusk.

18. Learn about the Yasawiyya Sufi order and its poetry in Turkic tongues.
19. Walk the steppe at sunset to feel the vastness that shaped Yasawi's mysticism.
20. Come with an open heart—Turkistan is a place of pilgrimage as much as tourism.

Shymkent, Kazakhstan

Halal food is available everywhere in Shymkent, and Islamic culture is the warmth of the south — bazaars, masjids, and the gateway to sacred Turkistan.

Shymkent is Kazakhstan's warm, sprawling southern capital—closer in spirit to Samarkand than to Astana, with bustling bazaars, shady parks, and the ancient city of Sayram at its shoulder. It is the relaxed, hospitable gateway to the country's south.

20 Things to Do in Shymkent

1. Visit Abay Park, the city's beloved green heart with its war memorial.
2. Wander the Dendropark's shaded avenues of rare trees.
3. Explore the Regional Museum of local history and archaeology.
4. Haggle in the Upper Bazaar, a true Central Asian market in full swing.
5. See the fountains and monuments of Ordabasy Square.
6. Relax along the Koshkar Ata river embankment.
7. Visit the Ken Baba ethnographic park for Kazakh nomadic culture.
8. See the towering Baidibek Ata monument complex.
9. Visit the Central Cathedral Masjid and the city's historic masajid.
10. Feast in the city famous for its food—Shymkent plov, samsa, and grilled meats; halal is simply how things are.
11. Take a day trip to Sayram, a 3,000-year-old Silk Road city, birthplace of Ahmed Yasawi.
12. Day-trip to the Aksu-Zhabagly Nature Reserve—wild tulips and mountain scenery.
13. Hike in the Sairam-Ugam National Park's alpine valleys.
14. Take a day trip to Turkistan and the Yasawi Mausoleum.
15. Watch traditional horseback games and wrestling at regional festivals.
16. Visit Independence Park and its modern monuments.
17. Enjoy the city's chaikhanas—long lunches over green tea are the local art form.
18. Browse for dried fruits, nuts, and spices to carry home.
19. Stroll the evening parks when the whole city comes out to cool off.
20. Experience southern Kazakh hospitality—generous, unhurried, and warm.

Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

Halal food is available everywhere in Bishkek, and Islamic culture fills the green capital — grand masjids and halal kitchens beneath the Tian Shan.

Bishkek is the greenest capital in Central Asia—a city of trees and mountain views where the Tian Shan fills the southern horizon from almost every street. Calm, affordable, and friendly, it is the perfect base for Kyrgyzstan's legendary alpine adventures.

20 Things to Do in Bishkek

1. Stand in Ala-Too Square beneath the great Manas statue and watch the changing of the guard.
2. Dive into Osh Bazaar—felt rugs, dried fruits, spices, and the full Central Asian market experience.
3. Take a day trip to Ala-Archa National Park: glaciers, waterfalls, and alpine meadows an hour from downtown.
4. Visit the State History Museum on the main square.
5. Relax in Panfilov and Oak parks, the city's leafy lungs.
6. Explore Dordoy Bazaar, one of Asia's largest markets, a city of shipping containers.
7. Feast on Kyrgyz cuisine—beshbarmak, lagman, manti, and kymyz; halal food is the standard everywhere.
8. Walk the Erkindik Boulevard's tree-shaded promenade.
9. Visit the grand new Central Masjid of Bishkek, one of the largest in Central Asia.
10. Take a day trip to the Burana Tower, a minaret of the ancient Silk Road city of Balasagun.
11. Day-trip to the Issyk-Ata gorge and its waterfall.
12. Soak in the Alamedin hot springs outside the city.
13. Drive into the Chunkurchak gorge for hiking and panoramic views.
14. Visit the Konorchek canyons' red rock formations on the road east.
15. Experience a yurt dinner at the Supara ethno-complex.
16. Shop for shyrdak felt carpets and Kyrgyz handicrafts.
17. Visit the Frunze House Museum and the city's Soviet-era curiosities.
18. Attend a performance at the Opera and Ballet Theatre for a few dollars.
19. Sip tea or kymyz at a mountainside chaikhana.
20. Use Bishkek as your launchpad to Issyk-Kul, Song-Kul, and the great Kyrgyz outdoors.

Dushanbe, Tajikistan

Halal food is available everywhere in Dushanbe, and Islamic culture flows through Persian poetry and prayer — chaikhanas and masjids beneath the mountains.

Dushanbe is Central Asia's gentlest capital—rose-filled parks, Persian poetry on every monument, and chaikhanas where hours dissolve over green tea and plov. From here the legendary Pamir Highway begins, one of the world's great road trips.

20 Things to Do in Dushanbe

1. Stroll Rudaki Avenue, the grand tree-lined spine of the city.
2. Visit the National Museum of Tajikistan and its giant reclining Buddha.
3. Admire the golden statue of Ismoil Somoni, founder of the Samanid empire.
4. See the Dushanbe Flagpole, once the tallest in the world, in its park by the palace.
5. Explore the National Library, one of the largest in Central Asia.
6. Take tea at the ornate Navruz Palace, a palace of carved wood and mirrors.
7. Sip osh and tea at the beloved Chaikhana Rokhat, a Soviet-era classic.
8. Shop the Mehrgon bazaar for pomegranates, dried apricots, and mountain honey.
9. Visit the Gurminj Museum of traditional Pamiri musical instruments.
10. Feast on qurutob, Tajikistan's national dish—halal, hearty, and unforgettable.
11. Walk Victory Park above the city for mountain-framed views.
12. Relax in the Botanical Garden's shaded hills.
13. See the Independence (Istiqlol) complex and its tower.
14. Attend a performance at the Ayni Opera and Ballet Theatre.
15. Take a day trip to the Hissar Fortress, the restored citadel of the Bukhara emirate's frontier.
16. Day-trip into the Varzob Gorge for riverside picnics and mountain air.
17. Venture to the turquoise Iskanderkul Lake, Alexander the Great's legendary resting place.
18. See the vast Nurek Dam on a day trip south.
19. Visit the Rudaki mausoleum region if you follow the poet's trail toward Panjakent.
20. Plan your Pamir Highway expedition—Dushanbe is where the great adventure begins.

SOUTHEAST AND SOUTH ASIA

Bali, Indonesia

Halal food is easy to find in Bali — Muslim-owned warungs, seafood grills, and halal-certified kitchens across the island — and Bali's own Muslim communities add their thread to the island's culture.

Bali is the Island of the Gods—emerald rice terraces, temple gates framing volcanoes, and a Hindu culture of daily offerings that perfumes the air with frangipani and incense. While Bali is Hindu-majority, Muslim travelers are warmly welcomed, and halal warungs, seafood grills, and masajid are easy to find across the island.

20 Things to Do in Bali

1. Watch the kecak fire dance at Uluwatu Temple as the sun sinks into the ocean.
2. Wander the Tegalalang Rice Terraces at dawn.
3. Visit Ubud's Sacred Monkey Forest Sanctuary.
4. Bathe in the holy springs of Tirta Empul water temple.
5. Climb Mount Batur for sunrise above the clouds.
6. Chase waterfalls—Tegenungan, Tibumana, and mighty Sekumpul.
7. Day-trip to Nusa Penida for the Kelingking cliffs and snorkeling with mantas.
8. Photograph the Gates of Heaven at Lempuyang Temple framing Mount Agung.
9. See Tanah Lot temple silhouetted on its sea rock at sunset.
10. Visit Ulun Danu Beratan, the floating temple on the mountain lake.
11. Enjoy Jimbaran Bay's grilled seafood on the beach at sunset—a beloved halal-friendly feast.
12. Seek out the island's many halal-certified warungs and Muslim-owned cafés, especially in Jimbaran, Kuta, and Denpasar.
13. Take a Balinese cooking class—most dishes adapt beautifully to halal.
14. Go white-water rafting on the Ayung River through jungle gorges.
15. Walk the Campuhan Ridge at golden hour.
16. Snorkel or dive the reefs and the USAT Liberty wreck at Amed and Tulamben.
17. Indulge in Bali's famous affordable spa and massage culture.
18. Ride the jungle swings and zip-lines above the rice fields.
19. Tour a coffee plantation and taste kopi luwak and herbal teas.
20. Simply slow down—Bali's real magic is its pace.

Yogyakarta, Indonesia

Halal food is available everywhere in Yogyakarta, a deeply Muslim royal city where masjids and centuries of Islamic scholarship sit beside the greatest temples of Java.

Yogyakarta is the cultural heart of Java—a living royal city ruled by a sultan, flanked by two of the world's greatest temples, Borobudur and Prambanan. With a deeply rooted Muslim culture, halal food on every corner, and gentle Javanese hospitality, it is Southeast Asia's most rewarding city for Muslim travelers.

20 Things to Do in Yogyakarta

1. Watch sunrise over Borobudur, the world's largest Buddhist temple, emerging from the mist.
2. Explore Prambanan, the soaring Hindu temple complex, at golden hour.
3. Tour the Kraton, the Sultan's still-living royal palace.
4. Wander the ruins and pools of Taman Sari, the sultans' water castle.
5. Stroll Malioboro Street at night—horse carts, batik, and street food.
6. Take a jeep tour up the slopes of Mount Merapi volcano.
7. Descend into Jomblang Cave and stand in its heavenly shaft of light.
8. Ride the hand-pulled gondola at Timang Beach over crashing waves.
9. Learn batik-making in a workshop and wear your own creation.
10. Explore the silver workshops of old Kotagede.
11. Taste gudeg, Jogja's sweet jackfruit stew—the city is majority Muslim and halal food is everywhere.
12. Watch the Ramayana Ballet under the stars with Prambanan lit behind the dancers.
13. Try the angkringan street-food carts—rice parcels, skewers, and sweet tea.
14. Sit between the twin banyan trees of Alun-Alun Kidul at night.
15. Visit the Sono-Budoyo Museum and its wayang puppet performances.
16. Catch the sunset from the hilltop ruins of Ratu Boko palace.
17. Go cave tubing through the underground river of Pindul.
18. Visit the Ullen Sentalu Museum of Javanese art and culture.
19. Watch black-sand waves pound Parangtritis Beach.
20. Feel the unhurried rhythm of a city that still bows to tradition.

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

Halal food is available everywhere in Kuala Lumpur — perhaps the easiest big city on earth for Muslim travelers, with masjids and halal kitchens in every district.

Kuala Lumpur is Southeast Asia's great crossroads—twin towers soaring over Mughal-style masajid, sizzling street food from three cultures, and rainforest still standing in the city centre. For Muslim travelers, it may be the easiest big city on earth: halal food is the default, and masajid are everywhere.

20 Things to Do in Kuala Lumpur

1. Gaze up at the Petronas Twin Towers and walk the skybridge.
2. Watch the Lake Symphony fountain show in KLCC Park at night.

3. Climb the rainbow steps of Batu Caves to its golden Murugan statue.
4. Visit Masjid Negara, the National Masjid, with its blue umbrella roof.
5. Explore the Islamic Arts Museum Malaysia—one of the finest in the world.
6. Visit the historic Jamek Masjid where the city's two rivers meet.
7. Stand in Merdeka Square, where independence was declared.
8. Feast on Jalan Alor and in Kampung Baru—halal street food from every corner of Asia.
9. Shop and snack through Central Market and Petaling Street.
10. Visit the Thean Hou Temple, a tiered beauty above the city.
11. Walk the canopy bridge in the KL Forest Eco Park—rainforest in the city.
12. Meet the hornbills at the KL Bird Park, the world's largest walk-in aviary.
13. Go up the KL Tower for sunset over the skyline.
14. Browse the fabric and spice lanes of Masjid India.
15. Take a day trip to Putrajaya to see the pink-domed Putra Masjid.
16. Day-trip to historic Malacca, the UNESCO port city of the straits.
17. Escape to the cool Genting Highlands by cable car.
18. Splash at Sunway Lagoon, the vast theme-park city.
19. Explore Little India in Brickfields for banana-leaf meals.
20. Enjoy the view from a rooftop at dusk as the twin towers light up.

Penang, Malaysia

Halal food is available everywhere in Penang — the nasi kandar capital — and Islamic culture anchors George Town through landmarks like the Kapitan Keling Masjid.

Penang is Malaysia's soul food—literally. George Town's UNESCO-listed shophouses, clan temples, and masajid frame the country's greatest street-food scene, where Malay, Chinese, and Indian Muslim kitchens have perfected their craft for two centuries. Come hungry.

20 Things to Do in Penang

1. Wander George Town's UNESCO streets hunting for its famous street art murals.
2. Feast at the hawker centres—Penang is Malaysia's food capital, with countless halal-certified stalls.
3. Try nasi kandar, the Indian Muslim rice-and-curry tradition born right here.
4. Slurp a bowl of Penang laksa and assam laksa at the famous stalls.
5. Visit the Kapitan Keling Masjid, the Indian Muslim community's landmark since 1801.
6. Ride the funicular up Penang Hill for views and cool air.
7. Explore Kek Lok Si, the largest Buddhist temple in Malaysia, with its towering Kuan Yin statue.

8. Tour the indigo-blue Cheong Fatt Tze Mansion.
9. Visit the Khoo Kongsi clan house, a masterpiece of Chinese craftsmanship.
10. Walk the Clan Jetties, stilt villages over the water.
11. Stroll Armenian Street and the heritage core at dusk.
12. Visit the opulent Pinang Peranakan Mansion.
13. Relax and parasail at Batu Ferringhi beach.
14. Hike Penang National Park to Monkey Beach and the meromictic lake.
15. Walk among butterflies at Entopia.
16. See Fort Cornwallis and the old Esplanade.
17. View the island from the Rainbow Skywalk atop Komtar.
18. Taste the king of fruits at the durian farms of Balik Pulau in season.
19. Explore Little India's sari shops and spice scent.
20. Eat again—nobody visits Penang just once.

Langkawi, Malaysia

Halal food is available everywhere in Langkawi, and Islamic culture is part of island life in Muslim-majority Kedah — halal seafood shacks and village masjids abound.

Langkawi is the Jewel of Kedah—99 islands of jungle-cloaked limestone, white beaches, and ancient mangroves in the Andaman Sea. As part of Muslim-majority Malaysia, halal food is effortless here, and the duty-free island is made for slow, sun-soaked days.

20 Things to Do in Langkawi

1. Ride the SkyCab cable car up Gunung Mat Cincang for jaw-dropping views.
2. Walk the curved Langkawi Sky Bridge above the rainforest canopy.
3. Relax on Pantai Cenang, the island's lively main beach.
4. Take a mangrove safari through the Kilim Geoforest Park—eagles, caves, and limestone karsts.
5. Go island-hopping to Pulau Dayang Bunting and its freshwater lake.
6. Photograph the giant eagle of Dataran Lang at sunset.
7. Swim beneath the Seven Wells (Telaga Tujuh) waterfalls.
8. Feast on halal seafood at the beach shacks and night markets—Langkawi's Malay kitchens never disappoint.
9. Explore the rotating pasar malam night markets for satay and kuih.
10. Visit the Underwater World aquarium at Cenang.
11. Take a sunset cruise across the Andaman Sea.
12. Learn the legend of Mahsuri at her tomb and cultural village.
13. Drive or scooter around the island's quiet rice-paddy backroads.
14. Try jet-skiing, parasailing, or island-hopping by speedboat.
15. Relax on the powdery white sand of Tanjung Rhu.

16. Visit the Langkawi Wildlife Park with the kids.
17. Soak in the Air Hangat hot springs village.
18. Snorkel the coral gardens of Pulau Payar Marine Park on a day trip.
19. Shop duty-free—chocolate, kitchenware, and gifts at island prices.
20. Watch hornbills glide over the rainforest at dawn.

Malé, Maldives

Halal food is available everywhere in Malé — the Maldives is a 100% Muslim nation — and Islamic culture is the island's very foundation, from coral-stone masjids to daily life.

Malé is one of the world's smallest, densest capitals—a colourful island city of coral-stone masajid, fish markets, and harbour views, floating in a turquoise sea. As a 100% Muslim nation, the Maldives is fully halal, and Malé shows you the real island life beyond the resorts.

20 Things to Do in Malé

1. Visit the Old Friday Masjid (Hukuru Miskiy), carved from coral stone in 1658—dress modestly.
2. Admire the golden dome of the Grand Friday Masjid and Islamic Centre.
3. Experience the dawn chaos of the Malé Fish Market as the tuna boats come in.
4. Browse the Local Market for Maldivian snacks, dried fish, and tropical fruit.
5. Walk the waterfront and watch the speedboats, seaplanes, and dhonis.
6. Visit the National Museum in Sultan Park.
7. Take the ferry to Hulhumalé, the reclaimed island with a long beach.
8. Escape to quiet Vilimalé island, the old "village" district.
9. Try mas huni and garudhiya—Maldivian breakfast and fish broth; everything in the country is halal.
10. Watch the sunset from the Artificial Beach with local families.
11. Take a day-trip snorkeling excursion to nearby reefs and sandbanks.
12. Go on a dolphin cruise at dusk.
13. Book a picnic on an uninhabited island—the Maldives at its purest.
14. Join a night-fishing trip and barbecue your catch.
15. Photograph the colourful tower blocks and minarets from the harbour.
16. Visit the Mulee'aage palace and the old presidential quarter.
17. Stroll Republic Square and meet the famous pigeon flocks.
18. Take a surfing day trip to the nearby atoll breaks.
19. Ride in a seaplane—the most scenic flight on earth.
20. Slow to island time—the Maldives teaches you how.

Baa Atoll, Maldives

Halal food is available everywhere in Baa Atoll — the Maldives is fully Muslim — and Islamic culture graces the local islands among the manta rays and lagoons.

Baa Atoll is the Maldives' natural treasure—a UNESCO Biosphere Reserve where manta rays gather by the hundreds in Hanifaru Bay and coral reefs ring every island. It is barefoot luxury at its most beautiful, in a country where every meal is halal and every view is a screensaver.

20 Things to Do in Baa Atoll

1. Snorkel with manta rays in Hanifaru Bay during the season (roughly May to November)—one of the greatest marine spectacles on earth.
2. Dive the atoll's reefs, thilas, and coral gardens.
3. Watch for whale sharks, gentle giants of the atoll.
4. Relax on a sandbank picnic in the middle of the ocean.
5. Kayak the glass-calm lagoons at sunrise.
6. Take a sunset dolphin cruise.
7. Visit a local island like Dharavandhoo to experience everyday Maldivian life.
8. Enjoy world-class halal dining—Maldives resorts are fully halal, with alcohol confined to resort islands only.
9. Indulge in an overwater spa treatment above the lagoon.
10. Go night snorkeling to see the reef's after-dark shift change.
11. Learn to dive with a PADI course in the planet's prettiest classroom.
12. Join a coral-restoration programme and plant your own coral frame.
13. Take a traditional sunset fishing trip and grill your catch.
14. Stargaze from a dhoni deck—no light pollution, just the Milky Way.
15. Photograph the bioluminescent "sea of stars" when conditions align.
16. Spot turtles grazing on the house reefs.
17. Try jet-skiing, parasailing, or paddleboarding on the lagoon.
18. Dine underwater or on the beach under lantern light.
19. Visit local masajid and community islands to feel the atoll's gentle faith.
20. Arrive by seaplane—the descent over the atolls is worth the trip alone.

Hunza Valley, Pakistan

Halal food is available everywhere in Hunza, and Islamic culture shapes the valley — the Ismaili Muslim community's warmth and mountain masjids beneath the great peaks.

Hunza is the Shangri-La of the Karakoram—a valley of apricot orchards, thousand-year-old forts, and 7,000-metre peaks, along the legendary Karakoram Highway. Its people are famed for their warmth and longevity, and its scenery is simply beyond belief.

20 Things to Do in Hunza Valley

1. Explore Baltit Fort, the 700-year-old palace above Karimabad.
2. Visit Altit Fort and its restored Royal Garden.
3. Watch sunrise from Eagle's Nest as a wall of giant peaks catches fire.
4. Boat across the impossibly turquoise Attabad Lake.
5. Photograph the Passu Cones, the cathedral-like peaks of the upper valley.
6. Cross the Hussaini suspension bridge—if you dare.
7. Drive to Khunjerab Pass, the world's highest paved border crossing, at 4,693 metres.
8. Stand at the Rakaposhi viewpoint beneath a 7,788-metre giant.
9. Wander Ganish, the valley's oldest settlement, with its carved wooden masajid.
10. Feast on Hunza cuisine—chapshuro meat pies, apricot-oil dishes, and dried mulberries; the valley's food is wholesome and halal.
11. Try the famous walnut cake at Karimabad's beloved cafés.
12. See the spring apricot blossom (March–April) or autumn's gold (October–November).
13. Drive the Karakoram Highway, often called the Eighth Wonder of the World.
14. Visit the Hopper Glacier in the Nagar valley across the river.
15. Hike to Borith Lake above the Passu glacier.
16. Climb the Ondra Poygah community steps in Gulmit for the panorama.
17. Meet the locals—Hunza's Ismaili Muslim community is renowned for education and hospitality.
18. Shop for gemstones, apricot oil, and hand-woven wool in Karimabad bazaar.
19. Stargaze at Duikar, one of the highest villages, above the clouds.
20. Breathe—the air at 2,500 metres tastes different here.

Skardu, Pakistan

Halal food is available everywhere in Skardu, and Islamic culture fills the Baltistan mountains — ancient Tibetan-style masjids among the world's highest peaks.

Skardu is the gateway to the giants—the launching point for K2 and the great Karakoram expeditions, set among cold deserts, mirror lakes, and Tibetan-style forts. It is one of the most dramatically beautiful mountain towns on earth.

20 Things to Do in Skardu

1. Visit Shangrila Resort and the heart-shaped Lower Kachura Lake.
2. Hike to the wild, quieter Upper Kachura Lake.
3. Stay or dine at Shigar Fort, a 400-year-old palace lovingly restored.
4. Take a day trip to Khaplu and its grand wooden palace.
5. Cross the Deosai Plains—the "Land of Giants," one of the world's highest plateaus.

6. Photograph the cold desert dunes of Sarfaranga with snow peaks behind.
7. Stand beneath the roaring Manthokha Waterfall.
8. Boat on Satpara Lake beneath the mountains.
9. See the ancient Buddha rock carvings near Manthal village.
10. Visit the K2 Museum and the mountaineering history exhibits in town.
11. Begin—or dream of—the trek to K2 Base Camp and Concordia.
12. Explore the Katpana Cold Desert at sunset.
13. Wander Skardu bazaar for dried apricots, Pashmina wool, and local gems.
14. Feast on Balti cuisine—mamtu dumplings and apricot soup; everything is halal and home-cooked.
15. Drive the Basho Valley through forests to alpine meadows.
16. Visit the organic farms of Nansoq village.
17. See the valley bloom with apricot and cherry blossom in spring.
18. Fly in from Islamabad—one of the world's most scenic flights, past Nanga Parbat.
19. Visit the serene Soq Valley and its riverside villages.
20. Simply sit by the Indus at dusk as the great peaks fade to purple.

EAST AFRICA

Zanzibar City / Stone Town, Tanzania

Halal food is available everywhere in Stone Town, and Islamic culture is the soul of Zanzibar — a thousand years of Swahili Muslim heritage in coral stone.

Stone Town is the Swahili coast's jewel—a UNESCO labyrinth of carved doors, coral-stone palaces, and spice-scented alleys where Africa, Arabia, and India have mingled for a thousand years. With its overwhelmingly Muslim heritage, halal food is everywhere, and the call to prayer drifts over the rooftops at dusk.

20 Things to Do in Stone Town and Zanzibar

1. Get gloriously lost in Stone Town's labyrinth of alleys—every turn is a photograph.
2. Admire the famous carved doors of Zanzibar, each telling a family's story.
3. Feast at the Forodhani Gardens night market—Zanzibar pizza, seafood skewers, and sugarcane juice, all halal.
4. Take a spice farm tour—touch, smell, and taste cloves, vanilla, and cinnamon.
5. Visit the Old Fort, the island's oldest building, on the seafront.
6. See the House of Wonders and the old Sultan's Palace.
7. Reflect at the former slave market memorial and cathedral—a sobering, essential history.
8. Take a boat to Prison Island to meet the giant Aldabra tortoises.
9. Sail a traditional dhow at sunset—the classic Zanzibar evening.
10. Explore the Hamamni Persian Baths and the Old Dispensary's ornate balcony.
11. Dive or snorkel the coral gardens of Mnemba Atoll.
12. Day-trip to Jozani Forest to meet the rare red colobus monkeys.
13. Relax on the powder beaches of Nungwi and Kendwa on a day trip.
14. Swim with the tide at Nakupenda sandbank and feast on grilled seafood.
15. Take a dolphin-spotting trip to Kizimkazi.
16. Try Swahili cuisine—urojo soup, mishkaki skewers, and biryani with a coastal twist.
17. Visit the Freddie Mercury House, birthplace of the Queen legend.
18. Browse Darajani Market at dawn—spices, fish, and island life at full volume.
19. Watch the kitesurfers fly over the lagoon at Paje.
20. Sip spiced coffee in a rooftop café as Stone Town's minarets light up at dusk.

THAILAND

Satun, Thailand

Halal food is available everywhere in Satun, Thailand's Muslim-majority province — masjids and halal seafood villages make it the country's most Muslim-friendly coast.

Satun is Thailand's best-kept secret—a Muslim-majority province on the Andaman coast where halal food is the norm, fishing villages nestle under limestone karsts, and the islands of Tarutao National Park rise from turquoise water. This is the halal-friendly Thailand most travelers never find.

20 Things to Do in Satun

1. Explore the Tarutao National Marine Park, one of Thailand's first and finest island reserves.
2. Day-trip to Koh Lipe for powder beaches and snorkeling straight off the sand.
3. Hike to the viewpoint on Koh Adang overlooking Lipe's bays.
4. Discover the Satun UNESCO Global Geopark—Thailand's first—with its ancient limestone landscapes.
5. Kayak through the stone castle formations of Prasat Hin Pun Yod.
6. Explore the vast chambers of Phu Pha Phet Cave, among the largest in Thailand.
7. Boat into the Le Stegodon sea cave at low tide.
8. Visit the Khao To Ngai "time boundary," where rocks of two geological eras touch.
9. Relax on Koh Bulone, a quiet island of Muslim fishing villages and empty beaches.
10. Feast on fresh seafood and southern Thai-Muslim cuisine—the province is majority Muslim and halal food is everywhere.
11. Visit the local masajid and meet the welcoming Muslim communities of the coastal villages.
12. Explore Mu Ko Phetra National Park's beaches and viewpoints.
13. Cool off at Wang Sai Thong waterfall's natural pools.
14. Wander Thale Ban National Park's lake and jungle trails.
15. Visit the Satun National Museum in the historic Kuden Mansion.
16. Eat at Pak Bara pier's seafood stalls as the boats come in.
17. Browse the town's night market for southern Thai snacks and roti.
18. Birdwatch in the mangroves and mudflats of the coast.
19. Take a slow boat through the mangrove channels at sunset.
20. Enjoy a province where the call to prayer and the sound of the sea blend into one calm rhythm.

Koh Lanta, Thailand

Halal food is available everywhere on Koh Lanta, whose large Muslim community keeps Islamic culture at the heart of island life — masjids and halal kitchens line the beaches.

Koh Lanta is the Andaman's laid-back island—a long, unhurried stretch of beaches, mangroves, and stilt-house villages, with a large Muslim community whose masajid and halal kitchens make it Thailand's most comfortable island for Muslim travelers.

20 Things to Do in Koh Lanta

1. Watch the sunset from Long Beach (Phra Ae), the island's golden heart.
2. Swim at Kantiang Bay, often ranked among Asia's finest beaches.
3. Explore Mu Ko Lanta National Park and its lighthouse viewpoint at the island's tip.
4. Wander Lanta Old Town, a Chinese-Muslim stilt-house village over the water.
5. Feast on halal seafood—Koh Lanta's Muslim fishing community means halal restaurants line the island.
6. Take a boat trip to snorkel the emerald lagoon of Koh Rok.
7. Dive or snorkel the pinnacles of Koh Haa.
8. Swim through the dark tunnel into the Emerald Cave (Morakot) on Koh Muk.
9. Kayak the mangrove forests of Tung Yee Peng and visit its floating seafood village.
10. Meet the Chao Ley "sea gypsy" community at Sangka-U village.
11. Take a Thai cooking class—halal-friendly kitchens are easy to find here.
12. Relax on the quiet sands of Klong Nin and Bamboo Bay.
13. Trek the jungle trail to Klong Jark waterfall.
14. Visit the caves of Tham Khao Maikaeo on a guided jungle adventure.
15. Browse the Saladan night market for roti, curries, and fresh fruit shakes.
16. Dive the world-class sites of Hin Daeng and Hin Muang (advanced).
17. Volunteer an hour or two at Lanta Animal Welfare.
18. Rent a scooter and circle the island's coastal road at your own pace.
19. Do sunrise yoga on the beach as the island wakes.
20. Attend the Laanta Lanta festival if you visit in spring—the whole island celebrates.

INDIA

Kozhikode, India

Halal food is available everywhere in Kozhikode, India's halal food paradise — centuries of Muslim heritage, historic masjids, and the legendary Malabar biryani.

Kozhikode (Calicut) is the Malabar Coast's historic spice port—where Vasco da Gama landed in 1498, and where a centuries-old Muslim community has made the city India's halal food paradise. Biryani, halwa, and sea air: Kozhikode is Kerala at its most delicious.

20 Things to Do in Kozhikode

1. Walk Kozhikode Beach at sunset and climb the old lighthouse.
2. Stand on Kappad Beach, where Vasco da Gama stepped ashore in 1498.
3. Visit the Mishkal Masjid in Kuttichira, a stunning 14th-century wooden masjid built without nails in the Kerala style.
4. Explore the Kuttichira quarter's historic masajid, including the Muchundi Masjid with its rare stone inscriptions.
5. Feast on Kozhikode biryani—the city is famous across India for it, and the cuisine is proudly halal.
6. Shop and snack down SM Street (Mittayi Theruvu), the legendary halwa and spice street.
7. Dine at Paragon, the century-old restaurant that made Malabar cuisine famous.
8. Stroll Mananchira Square, the city's garden heart.
9. Watch traditional dhows (urus) being built by hand at Beypore port.
10. Visit the Pazhassi Raja Museum and its art and archaeology.
11. Take a day trip to the Thusharagiri waterfalls in the Western Ghats.
12. Watch migratory birds at the Kadalundi Bird Sanctuary estuary.
13. Visit the Tali Temple, a landmark of the city's shared Hindu-Muslim heritage.
14. Experience Kalaripayattu, the ancient martial art, at a CVN Kalari performance.
15. Day-trip to Sargaalaya crafts village to meet Kerala's artisans.
16. Walk the Conolly Canal banks in the evening.
17. Visit the Regional Science Centre and planetarium with the family.
18. Taste Malabar snacks—muttamala, unnakaya, and sulaimani tea in the old town.
19. Shop for spices—cardamom, pepper, and cinnamon—straight from the coast that named them.
20. Listen for the call to prayer mingling with temple bells—Kozhikode's harmony is its own monument.

Lakshadweep, India

Halal food is available everywhere in Lakshadweep — India's entirely Muslim islands — and Islamic culture has shaped these coral atolls for over a thousand years.

Lakshadweep is India's secret Maldives—36 coral atolls scattered across the Arabian Sea, home to a fully Muslim island community, pristine lagoons, and some of the least-spoiled reefs in Asia. Permits keep it exclusive; the lagoons keep it unforgettable.

20 Things to Do in Lakshadweep

1. Arrive at Agatti, where the airstrip sits on a sliver of coral between two blues.
2. Snorkel the Agatti lagoon—coral gardens begin metres from the beach.
3. Visit Bangaram, the uninhabited atoll of pure castaway beauty.
4. Dive the reefs and wrecks of Bangaram, including the Princess Royal shipwreck.
5. Stay on Kadmat, a long, slender island with a spectacular lagoon on both sides.
6. Visit Kavaratti, the capital, and its beautiful Ujra Masjid with its ornate ceiling.
7. See the marine aquarium on Kavaratti to meet the lagoon's residents.
8. Sail to Minicoy, the southern island with Maldivian culture, a lighthouse, and the Lava dance tradition.
9. Kayak the glass-calm lagoons at sunrise.
10. Try scuba diving—Lakshadweep is India's premier dive destination.
11. Feast on island cuisine—tuna mas, coconut-rich curries, and fresh reef fish; the islands are entirely Muslim and everything is halal.
12. Camp under the stars on Thinnakara's sandbank island.
13. Watch turtles nesting and hatching on protected beaches.
14. Visit Kalpeni and its dramatic storm-bank of coral boulders.
15. Birdwatch at the Pitti island sanctuary, a haven for terns.
16. Go lagoon fishing with local islanders and grill your catch on the beach.
17. Take a glass-bottom boat over the reefs if you prefer to stay dry.
18. Watch the sunset set the lagoon on fire—then look up for the stars.
19. Respect the permit system and the islands' gentle, conservative way of life—dress modestly on inhabited islands.
20. Disconnect completely—there is no better place on earth to do it.

Hyderabad, India

Halal food is available everywhere in Hyderabad, the city of the Nizams — four centuries of Islamic culture, grand masjids, and the biryani capital of India.

Hyderabad is the City of Pearls and the biryani capital of India—a 400-year-old Muslim-ruled city of Charminar's arches, Golconda's mighty fort, and opulent

Nizam-era palaces, now also India's tech powerhouse. For halal food lovers, it is paradise with a view.

20 Things to Do in Hyderabad

1. Stand beneath the Charminar, the 1591 icon at the heart of the old city.
2. Explore Golconda Fort and stay for the evening sound-and-light show.
3. Visit Mecca Masjid, one of India's largest masajid, built with soil from the holy city.
4. Tour the Chowmahalla Palace, the seat of the fabulously wealthy Nizams.
5. Get lost in the Salar Jung Museum, one man's astonishing collection of everything.
6. Eat Hyderabadi biryani at its source—Shadab, Paradise, or Bawarchi; the city is a halal food institution.
7. Try haleem during Ramadan, the slow-cooked delicacy Hyderabad guards fiercely.
8. Sip Irani chai with Osmania biscuits at Nimrah Cafe beside the Charminar.
9. Shop for bangles in Laad Bazaar, glittering for a kilometre.
10. Visit the Qutb Shahi Tombs, the garden necropolis of the Golconda kings.
11. Take high tea at the Taj Falaknuma Palace, the Nizam's "Mirror of the Sky."
12. Boat to the Buddha statue on Hussain Sagar lake.
13. Spend a day at Ramoji Film City, the world's largest film studio complex.
14. Walk the Tank Bund and Necklace Road in the evening breeze.
15. Visit the Birla Mandir, a white-marble temple above the city.
16. Explore the restored Moazzam Jahi Market for ice cream and architecture.
17. Climb to the Moula Ali shrine hill for the panorama.
18. Browse Shilparamam, the crafts village, for pearls and Bidri metalwork.
19. See the Taramati Baradari, the open pavilion of Golconda's singing courtesan.
20. Watch the old city's minarets and markets glow at dusk from the Charminar's upper arches.

Lucknow, India

Halal food is available everywhere in Lucknow, the city of Nawabs — the refined heart of India's Islamic culture, with imambaras, masjids, and legendary halal kebabs.

Lucknow is the city of Nawabs—the capital of Awadh's refined Muslim court, where etiquette (tehzeeb) became an art form, kebabs melt on the tongue, and labyrinthine imambaras hide secret passages. It is India's most gracious city, and perhaps its most delicious.

20 Things to Do in Lucknow

1. Enter the Bara Imambara and brave the Bhool Bhulaiya, its famous labyrinth of a thousand passages.

2. Visit the Chota Imambara, the glittering "Palace of Lights."
3. Photograph the Rumi Darwaza, the Turkish-style gateway that is the city's symbol.
4. Explore the British Residency ruins, frozen in the siege of 1857.
5. Feast at Tunday Kababi, home of the legendary melt-in-the-mouth galouti kebab—Lucknow is one of India's great halal food cities.
6. Try Awadhi biryani, korma, and sheermal bread in the old city's kitchens.
7. Visit the grand Jama Masjid with its soaring minarets.
8. Climb the Husainabad Clock Tower, India's answer to Big Ben.
9. Stroll Hazratganj, the elegant colonial-era shopping boulevard.
10. Shop for chikankari, Lucknow's exquisite hand embroidery.
11. Wander the vast lawns and statues of Ambedkar Memorial Park.
12. Visit the Shah Najaf Imambara on the riverbank.
13. See the ruined grandeur of the Kaiserbagh palace complex.
14. Admire La Martiniere College, a palace masquerading as a school.
15. Walk the Gomti Riverfront at dusk.
16. Try basket chaat at the Royal Cafe and kulfi in Aminabad market.
17. Visit the Picture Gallery and the Satkhanda tower.
18. Relax in Janeshwar Mishra Park, one of Asia's largest urban parks.
19. Taste the season's mangoes from the orchards of Malihabad—the Dussehri is king.
20. Listen for echoes of the Nawabs' tehzeeb—Lucknow still says "pehle aap" (after you), and means it.

RUSSIA

Kazan, Russia

Halal food is available everywhere in Kazan, and Islamic culture is proudly Tatar — the great Kul Sharif Masjid rises in the Kremlin as the symbol of Volga Islam.

Kazan is where Europe and Asia, Orthodoxy and Islam, meet as equals—the capital of Tatarstan, where the great white Kul Sharif Masjid rises inside a UNESCO Kremlin beside a golden cathedral. With a proud Tatar Muslim heritage and halal food on every street, it is Russia's most welcoming city for Muslim travelers.

20 Things to Do in Kazan

1. Visit the Kul Sharif Masjid inside the Kremlin—one of Europe's largest masajid and a symbol of Tatar Islam reborn.
2. Explore the Kazan Kremlin, a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
3. See the Annunciation Cathedral standing in harmony beside the masjid.
4. Stroll Bauman Street, the lively pedestrian artery of cafés, buskers, and fountains.
5. Feast on Tatar cuisine—echpochmak, chak-chak, and horse-meat kazy; Kazan is a halal food heaven.
6. Wander the Old Tatar Quarter (Staro-Tatarskaya Sloboda) and visit the Mardjani Masjid, the first stone masjid built in Kazan after Catherine the Great restored religious freedom.
7. Take a day trip to Bolgar, the UNESCO-listed ancient city where the Volga Bulgars embraced Islam in 922—one of the most important sites in Russian Islamic history.
8. Day-trip to the island-town of Sviyazhsk, a UNESCO treasure at the meeting of two rivers.
9. See the leaning Suyumbike Tower and its legends inside the Kremlin.
10. Photograph the Palace of Farmers and its bronze tree.
11. Visit the Kazan Family Center, the giant "wedding bowl" with a city panorama.
12. Walk the Kremlin Embankment and Millennium Park at sunset.
13. Visit the Temple of All Religions, a fantastical tribute to the world's faiths.
14. Explore the Tatarstan National Museum and the story of Volga Islam.
15. Ride up the Epiphany Cathedral bell tower for the best old-town view.
16. Attend a Tatar-language performance at the Kamal Theatre.
17. Visit the Raifa Monastery's lakeside serenity on a day trip.
18. Swim in the turquoise Blue Lakes outside the city in summer.

19. See Kazan Arena, a stadium of the 2018 World Cup, and the riverside sports parks.
20. Warm up in a traditional chaykhana with Tatar tea and honey cake—hospitality is a point of pride here.